GLOBAL WELL-POSEDNESS OF TRANSPORT–STOKES EVOLUTION FOR L1-INTERSECTION-LP DENSITIES INCLUDING CRITICAL L3

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Editorial note. Only selected claim counted; full author mathematical body and original reference keys retained. Other stated results remain uncounted context; the sketch-labelled controllability conclusion in AHL222 is not selected as a counted claim.

Allowed standard prerequisites (editorial).

- Standard functional analysis, measure theory and the author-cited classical theorems. Standard prior results stay cited; complete source-local proofs and definitions retained.

1. Introduction and earlier results

We consider the following transport-Stokes system:

$$\left\{\begin{array}{rcll} \partial_t \rho + \operatorname{div}(u\rho) &=& 0\,, & \text{on } \mathbb{R}^+ \times \mathbb{R}^3, \\ -\Delta u + \nabla q &=& -\rho e_3\,, & \text{on } \mathbb{R}^+ \times \mathbb{R}^3, \\ \operatorname{div} u &=& 0\,, & \text{on } \mathbb{R}^+ \times \mathbb{R}^3, \\ \lim\limits_{|x|\to\infty} |u| &=& 0, & \text{on } \mathbb{R}^+, \\ \rho(0,\cdot) &=& \rho_0\,, & \text{on } \mathbb{R}^3. \end{array}\right. \tag{1}$$

The system (1) has been derived in [25, 31] as a model for the sedimentation of a cloud of rigid particles in a viscous fluid in the case where inertia of both fluid and particles is neglected. Let us also mention that, recently, some systems coupling a transport equation and the Navier–Stokes equations have been obtained as hydrodynamic limits of the Vlasov–Navier–Stokes system in [23].

Existence and uniqueness of solutions to (1) has been proved in [25] for regular initial data density, and extended to the case where the initial density is in $L^1(\mathbb{R}^3)\cap L^\infty(\mathbb{R}^3)$ with finite first moment in [32]. A similar result, without the assumption on the finite first moment, has been proved in the parallel contribution [24]. In the former paper, the authors also present a well-posedness result for a transport-Stokes like model taking into account the correction to the effective viscosity, the initial probability density is assumed to be $W^{1,\infty}(\mathbb{R}^3) \cap W^{1,1}(\mathbb{R}^3)$ in this case. In the paper [28], the author proves global existence and uniqueness for $L^\infty(\mathbb{R}^3)$ initial densities in the case of bounded domain in $\mathbb{R}^3$ and $\mathbb{R}^2$ and also in the case of an infinite strip $\Omega = (0,1)\times\mathbb{R}$ with a flux condition. We refer also to the recent paper [18] where the author proves global existence and uniqueness in $\mathbb{R}^2$ for $L^1(\mathbb{R}^2)\cap L^\infty(\mathbb{R}^2)$ compactly supported initial densities as well as propagation of Hölder regularity of the boundary of the patch.

Let us finally mention the work in progress [5] regarding the wellposedness of the transport-fractional Stokes system.

Let us emphasize that the transport-Stokes system can be seen as a particular case of a large family of transport equations with a velocity given as the convolution of the density ρ with a kernel K. The main key in order to ensure uniqueness is to establish suitable stability estimates. The first result relying on the 1-Wasserstein distance was obtained by Dobrushin [8] in the case where $\rho \in \mathcal{P}_1(\mathbb{R}^3)$ and $K \in Lip(\mathbb{R}^3, \mathbb{R}^3)$. This result has been generalized since for more singular kernels but for which, in counterpart, the probability density ρ lies in $L^\infty(\mathbb{R}^3)$; we refer to the stability result by Hauray [21] in the case where the singular kernel (at origin) satisfies a compatibility condition that mainly ensures local integrability of K, ∇K. This result has been adapted from the 2-Wasserstein stability estimate obtained by Loeper [30] for the Vlasov–Poisson system with L^∞ probability measures. We finally refer to the paper by Duerinckx and Serfaty [37] where K is the gradient of Coulomb, logarithmic or Riesz kernel. Authors prove the mean field convergence for a large system of interacting particles by introducing a suitable distance built as Coulomb (or Riesz) metric which overcomes the stability issue encountered when considering the Coulomb case with Wasserstein metric.

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2. Statement of the main results

2.1. **Global existence and uniqueness result for $L^1\cap L^p$ initial densities where $p \geqslant 3$.** In this section, we state the first main result of this paper regarding the global existence and uniqueness of solutions to the transport-stokes system with lower regularity than in the previous results, that is for $L^1 \cap L^p$ initial densities where $p \geqslant 3$.

Let us fix a notation before to state precisely the statement. For $p \geqslant 1$, let E_p be the subspace of probability measures in $L^p(\mathbb{R}^3)$. In addition to the global existence and uniqueness issue, next result also establishes the validity of some well-known conservation laws and the existence of a flow map in a classical sense.

Theorem 2.1. *Let $p \geqslant 3$ and ρ_0 in E_p. Then there is a unique corresponding solution*

$$(u, q, \rho) \in C\left([0,+\infty), W^{2,p}\left(\mathbb{R}^3\right) \times W^{1,p}\left(\mathbb{R}^3\right) \times E_p\right)$$

if $p > 3$ and respectively for $p = 3$

$$(u, q, \rho) \in C\left([0,+\infty), \dot{W}^{2,3}\left(\mathbb{R}^3\right) \cap \dot{W}^{1,3}\left(\mathbb{R}^3\right) \cap \bigcap_{q \in (3,+\infty]} W^{1,q}\left(\mathbb{R}^3\right) \times W^{1,3}\left(\mathbb{R}^3\right) \times E_3\right)$$

of the transport-Stokes equation (1) in the sense of distributions, the density function satisfies the following conservation law: for any $t \geqslant 0$,

$$\|\rho(t)\|_{L^1(\mathbb{R}^3)} = \|\rho_0\|_{L^1(\mathbb{R}^3)} \quad \text{and} \quad \|\rho(t)\|_{L^p} = \|\rho_0\|_{L^p}. \tag{2}$$

The velocity and pressure (u, q) satisfy for $p > 3$ and all $t \geqslant 0$

$$\|u(t)\|_{W^{2,p}(\mathbb{R}^3)} + \|q(t)\|_{W^{1,p}(\mathbb{R}^3)} \leqslant C_p \|\rho(t)\|_{L^1(\mathbb{R}^3)\cap L^p(\mathbb{R}^3)}, \tag{3}$$

and for $p = 3$, $q \in (3, +\infty]$

$$\|\nabla u(t)\|_{W^{1,3}(\mathbb{R}^3)} + \|u(t)\|_{W^{1,q}(\mathbb{R}^3)} + \|q(t)\|_{W^{1,3}(\mathbb{R}^3)} \leqslant C_q \|\rho(t)\|_{L^1(\mathbb{R}^3)\cap L^3(\mathbb{R}^3)}. \tag{4}$$

Moreover,

$$u \in \begin{cases} C([0,+\infty), C^{1,\mu}\left(\mathbb{R}^3\right), & \text{if } p > 3, \\ C\left([0,+\infty), \mathrm{Log}-\mathrm{Lip}\left(\mathbb{R}^3\right)\right), & \text{if } p = 3, \end{cases} \tag{5}$$

where $\mu = 1 - 3/p$, see Definition 3.3 for more details on Log-Lipschitz spaces. Finally, for all $s \in [0, +\infty)$, there exists a unique

$$X(\cdot, s, \cdot) - \mathrm{Id} \in \begin{cases} C\left([0,+\infty), C^{1,\mu}\left(\mathbb{R}^3\right)\right), & \text{if } p > 3, \\ C\left([0,+\infty), C^{0,r_s}\left(\mathbb{R}^3\right)\right), & \text{if } p = 3, \end{cases} \tag{6}$$

where $r_s = e^{-Cs}$, with $C > 0$ a constant depending only on $\|\rho_0\|_{L^1(\mathbb{R}^3)\cap L^3(\mathbb{R}^3)}$, such that

$$\begin{cases} \partial_t X t, s, x) &= u(t, X(t, s, x)), & \forall\ t, s \in [0, +\infty), \\ X(s, s, x) &= x, & \forall\ s \in [0, +\infty), \end{cases} \tag{7}$$

and for any t in $[0, +\infty)$,

$$\rho(t, \cdot) = X(t, 0, \cdot)\#\rho_0. \tag{8}$$

In (8) the notation # stands for the push-forward of the measure which follows the symbol by the mapping which precedes the symbol.

Remark 2.2. The critical case where $p = 3$ can be seen as a counterpart of the famous result by Yudovich in [40] on the existence and uniqueness of the weak solutions with bounded vorticity of the 2D incompressible Euler equations. In particular, this result uses in a key manner that the velocity field is log-Lipschitz. A related result, with a conditional flavour, also holds in the case of the Vlasov–Poisson equations, see [30].

The most delicate part of the proof of Theorem 2.1 is the uniqueness issue. Indeed Theorem 2.1 is obtained by classical arguments from the following stability estimates where W_1 denotes the first Wasserstein distance defined for two probability measures ρ_1, ρ_2 by

$$W_1(\rho_1, \rho_2) := \inf_{\pi \in \Pi(\rho_1, \rho_2)} \int |x - y| d\pi(x, y),$$

where $\Pi(\rho_1, \rho_2)$ is the set of admissible transport plans π in $\mathcal{P}(\mathbb{R}^3 \times \mathbb{R}^3)$ having ρ_1 as first marginal and ρ_2 as second marginal.

Theorem 2.3. *Let $p \geqslant 3$. For any $R > 0$, there is $C > 0$ such that for any couple of initial densities (ρ_1^0, ρ_2^0) in E_p with $\max_{i=1,2}(\|\rho_i^0\|_{L^1(\mathbb{R}^3)}, \|\rho_i^0\|_{L^p(\mathbb{R}^3)}) \leqslant R$, if (u_1, ρ_1) and (u_2, ρ_2) satisfy the transport-Stokes equation (1) for any $t \geqslant 0$, then*

$$W_1(\rho_1(t), \rho_2(t)) \leqslant W_1(\rho_1^0, \rho_2^0)e^{Ct}, \quad \text{if } p > 3, \tag{9}$$

$$W_1(\rho_1(t), \rho_2(t)) \leqslant W_1(\rho_1^0, \rho_2^0)^{e^{-Ct}}, \quad \text{if } p = 3. \tag{10}$$

The proof of Theorem 2.3 is given in Section 4 and Theorem 2.1 is deduced from Theorem 2.3 in Section 5.

Remark 2.4. We emphasize that the existence and uniqueness result can be extended to the case of transport-Stokes system with an additional source term f in the right hand side of the Stokes equation provided that $f \in C([0, +\infty), L^1(\mathbb{R}^3) \cap L^p(\mathbb{R}^3))$.

2.2. **Analyticity of the flow map when $p > 3$.** Next, we prove that, in the case where $p > 3$, the flow map which describes the trajectories of these solutions is analytic with respect to time. In the rest of this paper we use the following notation

$$X(t, \cdot) := X(t, 0, \cdot)$$

with $X(t, 0, \cdot)$ defined in (7). The following result holds true.

Theorem 2.5. *Let $p > 3$, ρ_0 in E_p and (u, ρ) in $C([0, +\infty), W^{2,p} \times E_p)$ the unique corresponding solution of the transport-Stokes equation (1). Let $\mu := 1 - 3/p$. Then X, defined as above, is analytic from $[0, +\infty)$ to $C^{1,\mu}(\mathbb{R}^3)$.*

This result extends to the transport-Stokes system a result which was obtained for classical solutions of the incompressible Euler system by Chemin in [4], and reproved by various other methods see by, among others [7, 10, 12, 20, 26, 27, 36, 38].

To prove Theorem 2.5, the key point is to prove the following result.

Proposition 2.6. *There exists $T > 0$ depending only on $\|\rho_0\|_{L^1 \cap L^p}$ and two constants C_1 and C_0 depending only on $\|\rho_0\|$, T and μ such that for all $t \in [0, T]$ and for all $n \geqslant 1$,*

$$\|\partial_t^n X(t, \cdot)\|_{1,\mu} \leqslant (-1)^{n-1} n! \binom{1/2}{n} C_0^n C_1^{n-1}. \tag{11}$$

Above we have used, for any $n \geqslant 1$, the notation

$$\binom{1/2}{n} = \frac{(1/2)(1/2 - 1) \cdots (1/2 - n + 1)}{n!}; \tag{12}$$

which is extended by convention by $\binom{1/2}{0} = -1$. With this definition we observe that

$$(-1)^{n-1} \binom{1/2}{n} \geqslant 0.$$

Moreover, for all $n \geqslant 2$,

$$(-1)^{n-1} n! \binom{1/2}{n} \leqslant C \frac{n!}{2^n}. \tag{13}$$

Therefore to deduce Theorem 2.5 from Proposition 2.6, it is sufficient to combine (11) and (13) on any time interval of the form $[t, t + T]$. Indeed, since the velocity u depends on time only through the density ρ, this ensures that the ODE equation for the flow is autonomous, see also formula (64) for a self-contained integro-differential equation of the flow. Consequently we have stated Proposition 2.6 in the case where $t = 0$ for simplicity.

The proof of Proposition 2.6 is given in Section 6 and is based on the approach developed in [7] where authors prove analyticity of Lagrangian trajectories for several incompressible inviscid models including the 2D surface quasi-geostrophic equation, the 2D incompressible porous medium equation, the 2D and the 3D incompressible Euler equations and the 2D Boussinesq equations. It turns out that, for the transport-Stokes model, the Oseen kernel benefits from better integrability properties, compared to the kernels considered in [7], which allows us to consider an initial density function ρ_0 which is less regular than the initial data considered in [7].

Remark 2.7. In the case where $p = 3$, it is likely that the flow map X still benefits from Gevrey regularity from $[0, +\infty)$ to $C^{r_t}(\mathbb{R}^3)$. Such a result is proved in the case of the $2D$ incompressible Euler equations with bounded vorticity in [12] in the case where the fluid occupies the full space and in [39] in the case where the fluid occupies a bounded domain.

2.3. **Exact controllability of the transport-Stokes system.** Our third main result establishes the small-time global exact controllability of the transport-Stokes system when distributed forces are allowed in an arbitrary non-empty open subset of $\mathbb{R}^3$, in the case where the initial and final densities are in L^p_c with $p \geqslant 3$. Here the index c means that these densities are compactly supported.

Theorem 2.8. *Let $T > 0$, $p \geqslant 3$. Let ω a non-empty open subset of $\mathbb{R}^3$. Let ρ_0 and ρ_f in L^p_c. There exists (u, ρ) in $C([0,T), W^{2,p}(\mathbb{R}^3) \times L^p(\mathbb{R}^3))$ and analogously for $p = 3$, $u \in C([0,T], \dot{W}^{1,3}(\mathbb{R}^3) \cap \dot{W}^{2,3}(\mathbb{R}^3) \cap \bigcap_{q>3} L^q(\mathbb{R}^3))$, there are $f \in C_c(0,T, L^\infty(\mathbb{R}^3))$ and $g \in C_c(0,T, L^1(\mathbb{R}^3) \cap L^p(\mathbb{R}^3))$, both compactly supported in $(0,T) \times \omega$ such that*

$$\left\{ \begin{array}{rcll} \partial_t \rho + \operatorname{div}(\rho u) & = & g, & \text{on } \mathbb{R}^3, \\ -\Delta u + \nabla p & = & -\rho e_3 + f, & \text{on } \mathbb{R}^3, \\ \operatorname{div} u & = & 0, & \text{on } \mathbb{R}^3, \\ \rho(0) = \rho_0 & , & \rho(T) = \rho_f, & \text{on } \mathbb{R}^3. \end{array} \right.$$

Theorem 2.8 adapts to the case of the transport-Stokes system some earlier results obtained for the incompressible Euler equations in [6, 16, 17]. The proof follows closely a now well-known strategy, relying on Coron's return method and the existence of peculiar vector fields, which solves the Stokes system in the uncontrolled zone $\mathbb{R}^3 \setminus \omega$. For sake of completeness, we give a sketch of proof in Section 7. Let us also mention that results regarding the Lagrangian controllability could also be obtained, in the spirit of the results [13, 14, 22] in the case of the Euler equations and the result [15] in the case of the steady Stokes equations. The proof of Theorem 2.8 is given in Section 7.

2.4. **A few open questions on the transport-Stokes system.**

- It would be interesting to investigate whether the results obtained in this paper can be extended to the case of $\mathbb{R}^2$ and the case of domains with boundaries. We have already mentioned the recent paper [18] for the case of compactly supported initial densities in $L^1(\mathbb{R}^2) \cap L^\infty(\mathbb{R}^2)$ and the paper [28] where existence and uniqueness is proved in the case of bounded domain in $\mathbb{R}^3$ and $\mathbb{R}^2$ and also in the case of an infinite strip $\Omega = (0,1) \times \mathbb{R}$ with a flux condition. In both cases the density is assumed to be in L^∞. Regarding the issue of the regularity in time of the flow map, let us mention [20, 19, 27, 39] where the case of the incompressible Euler equations in domains with boundaries is tackled.
- Another question is whether or not the well-posedness part of our results could be extended to lower regularity by making use of the theory of renormalized or Lagrangian solutions in the spirit, for example, of [2, 29]. One natural goal in this direction would be to be able to deal with densities ρ which are merely measures, with the aim to tackle the mean field limit.
- It has been shown in [32] that if $\rho_0 = 1_{B_0}$ with B_0 the unit ball then the solution $\rho = 1_B$ remains a spherical patch for all time, more precisely there exists a constant $v \in \mathbb{R}^3$ such that (ρ, u) satisfies

$$\begin{aligned} (u(t,x), \rho(t,x)) &= (u_0(x - vt), \rho_0(x - vt)), \\ (u - v) \cdot n &= 0 \text{ on } \partial B, \end{aligned} \tag{14}$$

  where n is the unit outer normal vector. A natural question is then to investigate the reciprocal property, that is, if there exists a constant velocity v and a bounded domain B_0 for which (14) is satisfied then B_0 is necessarily a ball. Note that this type of characterisation of the ball has been proved in any dimension by [9, Theorem 1.1] in the case where u_0 is a Newtonian potential housed in a bounded open set G. The author shows that if u_0 is constant on ∂G then necessarily G is a ball.

  A related issue would be to investigate the spherical case in the two dimensional setting as well since well posedness of 2d patches were established in [18].

3. A few preliminary reminders

In this section we gather some classical material which is useful later on.

3.1. **Multivariable calculus tools.** We denote by $\mathbb{N}_0^3$ the set of three dimensional multi-indices $\alpha = (\alpha_1, \alpha_2, \alpha_3)$ endowed with the component-wise sum and difference and with a partial order

$$\alpha \leqslant \beta \Leftrightarrow \Big(\alpha_i \leqslant \beta_i, \quad \forall\, 1 \leqslant i \leqslant 3 \Big).$$

We introduce the following notations: for any $\alpha, \beta \in \mathbb{N}_0^3$, for any $y \in \mathbb{R}^3$, we set

$$|\alpha| := \alpha_1 + \alpha_2 + \alpha_3, \quad \alpha! := \alpha_1! \alpha_2! \alpha_3!, \quad \partial^\alpha := \partial_{x_1}^{\alpha_1} \partial_{x_2}^{\alpha_2} \partial^{\alpha_3}, \quad y^\alpha := (y_1^{\alpha_1})\,(y_2^{\alpha_2})\,(y_3^{\alpha_3})\,,$$

$$\binom{\alpha}{\beta} = \binom{\alpha_1}{\beta_1} \binom{\alpha_2}{\beta_2} \binom{\alpha_3}{\beta_3} = \frac{\alpha!}{\beta!(\alpha - \beta)!},$$

and we recall the classical Leibniz formula

$$\partial^\alpha(fg) = \sum_{\beta \leqslant \alpha} \left(\partial^\beta f\right)\left(\partial^{\alpha-\beta} g\right).$$

We introduce for all $n \geqslant 1$, $1 \leqslant s \leqslant n$ and $\alpha \in \mathbb{N}_0^3$ with $1 \leqslant |\alpha| \leqslant n$ the set $P_s(n,\alpha)$ of the

$$(k_1, \cdots, k_s; l_1, \cdots, l_s) \in \mathbb{N}_0^3 \times \cdots \times \mathbb{N}_0^3 \times \mathbb{N} \times \cdots \mathbb{N},$$

such that

$$0 < |k_j|, \quad 0 < l_1 < \cdots < l_s, \quad \sum_{j=1}^{s} k_j = \alpha, \quad \sum_{j=1}^{s} |k_j| l_j = n.$$

We now recall the following formula from [7, Lemma 3.2], which is useful for the proof of Proposition 2.6.

Lemma 3.1 (Multivariate Faà di Bruno formula)**.** *Let $g : \mathbb{R} \mapsto \mathbb{R}^3$ be a vector function C^∞ in the neighborhood of $x_0 \in \mathbb{R}$. Let $h : \mathbb{R}^3 \to \mathbb{R}$ be a scalar function C^∞ in the neighborhood of $y_0 = g(x_0)$. Define $f(x) := h(g(x)) : \mathbb{R} \to \mathbb{R}$. Then*

$$f^{(n)}(x_0) = n! \sum_{1 \leqslant |\alpha| \leqslant n} (\partial^\alpha h)(g(x_0)) \sum_{s=1}^{n} \sum_{P_s(n,\alpha)} \prod_{j=1}^{s} \frac{\left(\partial^{l_j} g)(x_0)\right)^{k_j}}{(k_j!)(l_j!)^{|k_j|}}, \tag{15}$$

holds for any $n \geqslant 1$, with the convention that $0^0 := 1$.

3.2. **Hölder, Lipschitz and log-Lipschitz spaces.** We introduce the following notations for Lipschitz, log-Lipschitz and Hölder spaces.

Definition 3.2 (Hölder spaces)**.** Let $\mu \in]0,1]$ and $n \in \mathbb{N}$

$$C^{n,\mu}\left(\mathbb{R}^3\right) := \left\{ \psi \in C^n(\mathbb{R}^3), \sum_{|\alpha| \leqslant n} \sup_{x \in \mathbb{R}^3} |\partial^\alpha \psi(x)| + \sum_{|\alpha|=n} [\partial^\alpha \psi]_{0,\mu} < +\infty \right\},$$

where

$$[\psi]_{0,\mu} := \sup_{x \neq y} \frac{|\psi(x) - \psi(y)|}{|x-y|^\mu}.$$

The space $C^{n,\mu}(\mathbb{R}^3)$ is endowed with the following norm

$$\|\psi\|_{n,\mu} := \sum_{i=0}^{n} \sup_{x \in \mathbb{R}^3} |\partial_i \psi(x)| + [\partial_n \psi]_{0,\mu}.$$

In the case of the space of Lipschitz functions $C^{0,1}(\mathbb{R}^3)$ we use the notation

$$\mathrm{Lip}(\psi) := \sup_{x \neq y} \frac{|\psi(x) - \psi(y)|}{|x-y|},$$

and set

$$\mathrm{Lip}\left(\mathbb{R}^3\right) := C^{0,1}\left(\mathbb{R}^3\right).$$

We introduce the following real function $\ln_-$

$$\ln\nolimits_-(s) := \max(0, -\ln(s)) = \begin{cases} -\ln(s) & \text{if} s \in [0,1], \\ 0 & \text{if} s \geqslant 1. \end{cases} \tag{16}$$

Definition 3.3 (Log-Lipschitz space)**.** We introduce the following notation for any function ψ

$$\mathrm{Log-Lip}(\psi) := \sup_{x \neq y} \frac{|\psi(x) - \psi(y)|}{|x-y|(1 + \ln_- |x-y|)}.$$

We say that a bounded continuous function ψ is Log-Lipschitz if $\mathrm{Log-Lip}(\psi) < +\infty$ and we set

$$\mathrm{Log-Lip}\left(\mathbb{R}^3\right) := \left\{ \psi \in C\left(\mathbb{R}^3\right), \|\psi\|_\infty + \mathrm{Log-Lip}(\psi) < +\infty \right\}.$$

3.3. **Steady Stokes equations.** Let $(\mathcal{U}, \mathcal{P})$ the Stokes Green function, also called the Oseen tensor, given by

$$\mathcal{U}(x) = \frac{1}{8\pi|x|}\left(Id + \frac{x\otimes x}{|x|^2}\right) \quad \text{and} \quad \mathcal{P}(x) = -\frac{1}{4\pi}\frac{x}{|x|^2}. \tag{17}$$

Let us observe that the Oseen tensor $\mathcal{U}$ satisfies the following bound:

$$|\mathcal{U}(x)| \leqslant C\frac{1}{|x|}, \ \forall\, x \in \mathbb{R}^3 \setminus \{0\}, \tag{18}$$

and

$$|\mathcal{U}(x) - \mathcal{U}(y)| \leqslant C|x-y|\left(\frac{1}{|x|^2} + \frac{1}{|y|^2}\right), \ \forall\, x, y \in \mathbb{R}^3 \setminus \{0\}. \tag{19}$$

Let us recall the following classical result on the Stokes equations, see for example [11, Theorem IV.2.1].

Proposition 3.4. *Let f in $L^p(\mathbb{R}^3) \cap L^1(\mathbb{R}^3)$ with $p \geqslant 3$. Then there is a unique solution of the Stokes equation*

$$\left\{\begin{array}{rcll} -\Delta u + \nabla\pi & = & f\,, & \text{in } \mathbb{R}^3, \\ \operatorname{div} u & = & 0\,, & \text{in } \mathbb{R}^3, \\ \lim\limits_{|x|\to\infty} |u| & = & 0, & \end{array}\right. \tag{20}$$

such that $(u,\pi) \in W^{2,p}(\mathbb{R}^3) \times W^{1,p}(\mathbb{R}^3)$ if $p > 3$ and $(\nabla u, \pi) \in W^{1,3}(\mathbb{R}^3) \times W^{1,3}(\mathbb{R}^3)$, $u \in W^{1,q}(\mathbb{R}^3)$ for any $q > 3$ in the case $p = 3$.

Moreover,

$$u = \mathcal{U} \star f \quad \text{and} \quad \pi = \mathcal{P} \star f. \tag{21}$$

3.4. **Sobolev embedding.** The reason why the value $p = 3$ appears in our analysis is due to the following result, which establishes that the unique velocity solution of the Stokes equation with data in $L^1 \cap L^p$ is Lipschitz when $p > 3$ and Log-Lipschitz in the critical case $p = 3$.

Proposition 3.5. *Let ρ in $L^p(\mathbb{R}^3) \cap L^1(\mathbb{R}^3)$ with $p \geqslant 3$, and (u,p) the unique corresponding solution in $W^{2,p}(\mathbb{R}^3) \times W^{1,p}(\mathbb{R}^3)$ (resp. in $\dot{W}^{2,3}(\mathbb{R}^3) \cap \dot{W}^{1,3}(\mathbb{R}^3) \cap W^{1,q}(\mathbb{R}^3) \times W^{1,3}(\mathbb{R}^3)$ for $p = 3$, $q \in (3, +\infty]$) of the Stokes equation* (20)*. Then*

$$u \in \begin{cases} \mathrm{Lip}\left(\mathbb{R}^3\right), & \text{if } p > 3, \\ \mathrm{Log-Lip}\left(\mathbb{R}^3\right), & \text{if } p = 3, \end{cases} \tag{22}$$

with the following estimates:

$$\mathrm{Lip}(u) \leqslant C\|\rho\|_{L^1(\mathbb{R}^3)\cap L^p(\mathbb{R}^3)}, \text{ if } p > 3, \tag{23}$$

$$\mathrm{Log-Lip}(u) \leqslant C\|\rho\|_{L^1(\mathbb{R}^3)\cap L^3(\mathbb{R}^3)} \text{ if } p = 3. \tag{24}$$

Proof. In the case where $p > 3$ we have the embedding $W^{2,p}(\mathbb{R}^3) \hookrightarrow W^{1,\infty}(\mathbb{R}^3)$, so that

$$\|u\|_{W^{1,\infty}(\mathbb{R}^3)} \leqslant C\|u\|_{W^{2,p}(\mathbb{R}^3)} \leqslant C\|\rho\|_{L^1(\mathbb{R}^3)\cap L^p(\mathbb{R}^3)}. \tag{25}$$

Let us now deal with the case where $p = 3$.

We provide here a self-contained proof which we will adapt later on in the proof of Theorem 2.3. First, by the convolution formula (21), we have

$$\begin{aligned} |u(x)| &\leqslant C\int_{B(x,1)} \frac{\rho(z)}{|x-z|}dz + \int_{B(x,1)^c} \frac{\rho(z)}{|x-z|}dz \\ &\leqslant \left(\int_{B(x,1)} \frac{dz}{|x-z|^2}\right)^{1/2} \|\rho\|_{L^2(\mathbb{R}^3)} + \|\rho\|_{L^1(\mathbb{R}^3)} \\ &\leqslant C\|\rho\|_{L^1(\mathbb{R}^3)\cap L^3(\mathbb{R}^3)}, \end{aligned}$$

where the notation $\cdot^c$ stands for the complementary set in $\mathbb{R}^3$.

Second, by the convolution formula (21), we obtain that for any $x \neq x'$ in $\mathbb{R}^3$,

$$|u(x) - u(x')| \leqslant I_1 + I_2,$$

where

$$I_1 := \int_{B(x,\epsilon)\cup B(x',\epsilon)} |\mathcal{U}(x-u)-\mathcal{U}(x'-u)|\,\rho(u)du,$$
$$I_2 := \int_{B(x,\epsilon)^c\cap B(x',\epsilon)^c} |\mathcal{U}(x-u)-\mathcal{U}(x'-u)|\,\rho(u)du,$$

with $\epsilon := |x-x'|$.

For I_1, by (18), we have

$$I_1 \leqslant C\left(\int_{B(x,\epsilon)}\frac{1}{|x-u|}\rho(u)du+\int_{B(x',\epsilon)}\frac{1}{|x-u|}\rho(u)du \right.$$
$$\left. +\int_{B(x,\epsilon)}\frac{1}{|x'-u|}\rho(u)du+\int_{B(x',\epsilon)}\frac{1}{|x'-u|}\rho(u)du\right).$$

Since $B(x,\epsilon)\subset B(x',2\epsilon)$ and $B(x',\epsilon)\subset B(x,2\epsilon)$ by the triangle inequality and the definition of ϵ, we have that

$$I_1 \leqslant C\left(\int_{B(x,2\epsilon)}\frac{1}{|x-u|}\rho(u)du+\int_{B(x',2\epsilon)}\frac{1}{|x'-u|}\rho(u)du\right)\leqslant C\epsilon\|\rho\|_{L^3(\mathbb{R}^3)},$$

by Hölder's inequality.

For I_2, by (18), we have

$$I_2 \leqslant C|x-x'|\int_{B(x,\epsilon)^c\cap B(x',\epsilon)^c}\left(\frac{1}{|x-u|^2}+\frac{1}{|x'-u|^2}\right)\rho(u)du$$
$$\leqslant C|x-x'|\left(\int_{B(x,\epsilon)^c}\frac{1}{|x-u|^2}\rho(u)du+\int_{B(x',\epsilon)^c}\frac{1}{|x'-u|^2}\rho(u)du\right).$$

If $\epsilon=|x-x'|\geqslant 1$ we have $I_2\leqslant C|x-x'|\|\rho\|_1$ and this yields the desired result. On the other hand, if $\epsilon<1$, then

$$\int_{B(x,\epsilon)^c}\frac{1}{|x-u|^2}\rho(u)du\leqslant\int_{B(x,2)\setminus B(x,\epsilon)}\frac{1}{|x-u|^2}\rho(u)du+\int_{B(x,2)^c}\frac{1}{|x-u|^2}\rho(u)du$$
$$\leqslant C\|\rho\|_{L^3(\mathbb{R}^3)}|\log(\epsilon)|+\|\rho\|_{L^1(\mathbb{R}^3)},$$

by Hölder's inequality. By combining the estimates we conclude the proof of (24). □

3.5. **Flow map and Osgood's lemma.** The following result on the existence and uniqueness of a classical flow in the case of Lipschitz or Log-Lipschitz vector fields is quite classical, let us refer for example to [1].

Proposition 3.6. *Let u a vector field in* (5)*. Then there exists a unique corresponding flow X such as in* (6) *and satisfying* (29)*.*

In order to recall Osgood Lemma we introduce first the notion of Osgood modulus of continuity, see [1, Definition 3.1] for more details.

Definition 3.7. Let $a>0$. A modulus of continuity $\eta:[0,a]\to[0,+\infty[$ is any continuous non-decreasing function vanishing at 0 and continuous at 0. We say that η is an Osgood modulus of continuity if in addition

$$\int_0^a\frac{dz}{\eta(z)}=\infty.$$

We recall Osgood lemma which will be useful for the proof of Theorems 2.1 and 2.3 in the critical case $p=3$.

Lemma 3.8 (Osgood Lemma)**.** *Let f a measurable function from $[t_0,T]$ to $[0,a]$, v a locally integrable function from $[t_0,T]$ to $\mathbb{R}^+$ and $\eta:[0,a]\to[0,+\infty[$ an Osgood modulus of continuity. Assume that there exists $c\geqslant 0$ such that for a.e $t\in[t_0,T]$*

$$f(t)\leqslant c+\int_{t_0}^t v(s)\,\eta(f(s))ds.$$

(1) *If $c>0$ then we have*

$$\mathcal{M}(c)\leqslant\mathcal{M}(f(t))+\int_{t_0}^t v(s)ds \text{ with } \mathcal{M}(x)=\int_x^a\frac{dz}{\eta(z)}.$$

(2) *If $c=0$ then $f=0$ a.e on $[t_0,T]$.*

4. Proof of Theorem 2.3

Let $p \geqslant 3$, $R > 0$, a couple of initial densities (ρ_1^0, ρ_2^0) in E_p with

$$\max_{i=1,2} \left(\left\| \rho_i^0 \right\|_{L^1(\mathbb{R}^3)}, \left\| \rho_i^0 \right\|_{L^p(\mathbb{R}^3)} \right) \leqslant R$$

and (u_1, ρ_1) and (u_2, ρ_2) in $C([0, +\infty), W^{2,p} \times E_p)$ satisfying the transport-Stokes equation (1) for any $t \geqslant 0$, with, respectively, ρ_1^0 and ρ_2^0 as initial condition.

Let us recall that if ρ_2 is absolutely continuous with respect to the Lebesgue measure then

$$W_1(\rho_1, \rho_2) = \inf_{T \# \rho_2 = \rho_1} \int_{\mathbb{R}^3} |T(x) - x| d\rho_2(x), \tag{26}$$

where the infimum runs over all measurable transport maps $T : \mathbb{R}^3 \to \mathbb{R}^3$ and there exists an optimal transport map T^* for which the infimum is reached, see [34, Theorem 1.5]. We emphasize that we use transport maps in the whole analysis for the sake of lightness and that one can adapt all the arguments using only optimal transport plans which are known to exist, see [35, Theorem 1.7].

We introduce T_0 the optimal transport map such that

$$\rho_1^0 = T_0 \# \rho_2^0, \tag{27}$$

and

$$W_1\left(\rho_1^0, \rho_2^0\right) = \int_{\mathbb{R}^3} |T_0(x) - x| \rho_2^0(x) dx. \tag{28}$$

For $i = 1, 2$, let X_i associated the characteristic flow with u_i by

$$\left\{ \begin{array}{rcll} \partial_t X_i(t,s,x) & = & u_i(s, X_i(t,s,x)), & \forall\ t, s \in [0, +\infty), \\ X_i(s,s,x) & = & x, & \forall\ s \in [0, +\infty), \end{array} \right. \tag{29}$$

For $i = 1, 2$, for any t in $[0, +\infty)$,

$$\rho_i(t, \cdot) = X_i(t, 0, \cdot) \# \rho_i^0. \tag{30}$$

We set, for any $t \geqslant 0$,

$$T_t := X_1(t, 0, \cdot) \circ T_0 \circ X_2(0, t, \cdot). \tag{31}$$

Let us define, for any $t \geqslant 0$,

$$Q(t) := \int_{\mathbb{R}^3} |T_t(x) - x| \rho_2^t(dx).$$

By (28), we observe that

$$W_1\left(\rho_1^0, \rho_2^0\right) = Q(0). \tag{32}$$

In what follows we use the shortcut $\rho_i^t := \rho_i(t, \cdot)$ for $t \geqslant 0$ and $i = 1, 2$. From (30), (27) and (31) we deduce that for any $t \geqslant 0$,

$$\rho_1^t = T_t \# \rho_2^t. \tag{33}$$

We therefore deduce from (26) and (33) that for any $t \geqslant 0$,

$$W_1(\rho_1^t, \rho_2^t) \leqslant Q(t). \tag{34}$$

Now, using (30) (with $i = 2$) and (31) (which implies that for any $t \geqslant 0$, $T_t \circ X_2(t, 0, \cdot) = X_1(t, 0, \cdot) \circ T_0$), we have for any $t \geqslant 0$,

$$Q(t) = \int_{\mathbb{R}^3} \left| X_1\left(t, 0, T_0(x)\right) - X_2(t, 0, x) \right| \rho_2^0(dx). \tag{35}$$

From (29) we deduce that for any x in $\mathbb{R}^3$, for any $t \geqslant 0$,

$$\begin{aligned} &|X_1(t, 0, T_0(x)) - X_2(t, 0, x)| \\ &\qquad \leqslant |T_0(x) - x| + \int_0^t \left| u_1(s, X_1(s, 0, T_0(x))) - u_2(s, X_2(s, 0, x)) \right| ds \\ &\qquad \leqslant |T_0(x) - x| + \int_0^t \left| u_1(s, X_1(s, 0, T_0(x))) - u_1(s, X_2(s, 0, x)) \right| ds \\ &\qquad\quad + \int_0^t \left| u_1(s, X_2(s, 0, x)) - u_2(s, X_2(s, 0, x)) \right| ds. \end{aligned} \tag{36}$$

To go further we need to distinguish the case where $p > 3$ and the case where $p = 3$.

4.1. **Case where $p > 3$.** Let us first deal with the case where $p > 3$. Then by Proposition 3.5, the velocity field u_1 is Lipschitz and therefore for any $t \geqslant 0$,

$$\begin{aligned}\big|X_1(t,0,T_0(x)) - X_2(t,0,x)\big| \leqslant |T_0(x) - x| \\ + \int_0^t \mathrm{Lip}(u_1(s))\big|X_1(s,0,T_0(x)) - X_2(s,0,x)\big|ds \\ + \int_0^t \big|u_1(s,X_2(s,0,x)) - u_2(s,X_2(s,0,x))\big|ds.\end{aligned}$$

By integration over $\mathbb{R}^3$ with respect to the measure $\rho_2^0(dx)$, we deduce by using (30) and (35) that for any $t \geqslant 0$,

$$Q(t) \leqslant Q(0) + \int_0^t \mathrm{Lip}(u_1(s))Q(s)ds + \int_0^t \int |u_1(s,x) - u_2(s,x)|\rho_2^s(dx)ds. \tag{37}$$

Let us now estimate the last term in the right hand side of (37). By using the convolution formula (21) and (33) we obtain that for any $s \geqslant 0$,

$$\begin{aligned}\int_{\mathbb{R}^3} |u_1(s,x) - u_2(s,x)|\rho_2^s(x)dx \\ = \int_{\mathbb{R}^3} \left| \int_{\mathbb{R}^3} (\mathcal{U}(x - T_s(y)) - \mathcal{U}(x-y))e_3\rho_2^s(y)dy \right| \rho_2^s(dx).\end{aligned} \tag{38}$$

Thus we deduce from (38) and (19) that for any $s \geqslant 0$,

$$\begin{aligned}\int_{\mathbb{R}^3} |u_1(s,x) - u_2(s,x)|\rho_2^s(x)dx \\ \leqslant C \int_{\mathbb{R}^3} \left| \int_{\mathbb{R}^3} |T_s(y) - y| \left(\frac{1}{|x-y|^2} + \frac{1}{|x - T_s(y)|^2} \right) \rho_2^s(y)dy \right| \rho_2^s(dx),\end{aligned}$$

Therefore, by Fubini's principle, for any $s \geqslant 0$,

$$\int_{\mathbb{R}^3} |u_1(s,x) - u_2(s,x)|\rho_2^s(x)dx \leqslant I_1(s)Q(s), \tag{39}$$

where

$$I_1(s) := \sup_y \int_{\mathbb{R}^3} \left(\frac{1}{|x-y|^2} + \frac{1}{|x - T_s(y)|^2} \right) \rho_2^s(x)dx.$$

The integral corresponding to the first term in $I_1(s)$ can be estimated for all y in $\mathbb{R}^3$ and for all $s \geqslant 0$ as follows:

$$\begin{aligned}\int_{\mathbb{R}^3} \frac{1}{|x-y|^2}\rho_2^s(x)dx &\leqslant \int_{B(y,1)} \frac{1}{|x-y|^2}\rho_2^s(x)dx + \int_{B(y,1)^c} \rho_2^s(dx) \\ &\leqslant \left(\int_{B(y,1)} \frac{1}{|x-y|^{2p'}} \right)^{1/p'} \|\rho_2^s\|_{L^p(\mathbb{R}^3)} + \|\rho_2^s\|_{L^1(\mathbb{R}^3)},\end{aligned}$$

by Hölder's inequality, with $p' = p/(p-1) < 3/2$, so that $z \mapsto z^{2-2p'}$ is integrable near the origin, and therefore

$$\begin{aligned}\int_{\mathbb{R}^3} \frac{1}{|x-y|^2}\rho_2^s(x)dx &\leqslant C\|\rho_2^s\|_{L^p(\mathbb{R}^3)} \int_0^1 z^{2-2p'}dz + \|\rho_2^s\|_{L^1(\mathbb{R}^3)} \\ &\leqslant C\big(\|\rho_2^s\|_{L^p(\mathbb{R}^3)} + \|\rho_2^s\|_{L^1(\mathbb{R}^3)}\big).\end{aligned}$$

Proceeding similarly for the second term in $I_1(s)$, we arrive at

$$I_1(s) \leqslant C\big(\|\rho_2^s\|_{L^p(\mathbb{R}^3)} + \|\rho_2^s\|_{L^1(\mathbb{R}^3)}\big), \tag{40}$$

for any $s \geqslant 0$. Combining (37), (39) and (40) we get that for any $t \geqslant 0$,

$$Q(t) \leqslant Q(0) + \int_0^t \mathrm{Lip}(u_1(s))Q(s)ds + \int_0^t C\big(\|\rho_2^s\|_{L^p(\mathbb{R}^3)} + \|\rho_2^s\|_{L^1(\mathbb{R}^3)}\big)Q(s)ds.$$

By using $\|\rho_i^t\|_{L^q(\mathbb{R}^3)} = \|\rho_i^0\|_{L^q(\mathbb{R}^3)}$ for $q = 1, p$ and $i = 1, 2$, (25) and a Gronwall-type argument, and combining this with (34) and (32) we arrive at (9). This concludes the proof of Theorem 2.3 in the case where $p > 3$.

4.2. **Case where $p = 3$.** Let us now deal with the critical case where $p = 3$. By using (36) and Proposition 3.5, we obtain that for any x in $\mathbb{R}^3$, for any $t \geqslant 0$,

$$\begin{aligned}\big|X_1(t,0,T_0(x)) - X_2(t,0,x)\big| &\leqslant |T_0(x) - x| \\ &\quad + C\int_0^t \big|X_1(s,0,T_0(x)) - X_2(s,0,x)\big|\big(1 + \ln_-(|X_1(s,0,T_0(x)) - X_2(s,0,x)|\big)ds \\ &\quad + \int_0^t \big|u_1(s,X_2(s,0,x) - u_2(s,X_2(s,0,x)\big|ds,\end{aligned}$$

where $C = C(\|\rho_1^0\|_{L^3(\mathbb{R}^3)\cap L^1(\mathbb{R}^3)}) > 0$. By integration over $\mathbb{R}^3$ with respect to the measure $\rho_2^0(dx)$, we deduce by using (30) and (35) that for any $t \geqslant 0$,

$$\begin{aligned}Q(t) \leqslant Q(0) + \int_0^t \int_{\mathbb{R}^3} \big|u_1(s,X_2(s,0,x) - u_2(s,X_2(s,0,x)\big|\rho_2^0(dx)ds \\ + C\int_0^t \int_{\mathbb{R}^3} \eta\big(|X_1(s,0,T_0(x)) - X_2(s,0,x)|\big)\rho_2^0(dx)ds\end{aligned}$$

with $\eta(z) = z(1 + \ln_-(z))$. Since η is concave for $z \geqslant 0$, it follows from Jensen's inequality and (35) that for any $s \geqslant 0$,

$$\int_{\mathbb{R}^3} \eta\left(|X_1(s,0,T_0(x)) - X_2(s,0,x)|\right)\rho_2^0(dx) \leqslant \eta\left(Q(s)\right).$$

Therefore, for any $t \geqslant 0$,

$$Q(t) \leqslant Q(0) + C\int_0^t \eta\left(Q(s)\right)ds + \int_0^t \int_{\mathbb{R}^3} |u_1(s,x) - u_2(s,x)|\rho_2^s(x)dxds. \tag{41}$$

To bound the last term above, we establish the following result.

Lemma 4.1. *For any $t \geqslant 0$,*

$$\int \big|u_1(t,x) - u_2(t,x)\big|\rho_2(t,x)dx \leqslant C\left(\left\|\rho_2^t\right\|_{L^1\cap L^3}\right)Q(t)(1 + \ln_- Q(t)). \tag{42}$$

Proof. By (38) and Fubini's principle, we obtain that for any $t \geqslant 0$,

$$\begin{aligned}\int_{\mathbb{R}^3} |u_1(t,x) - u_2(t,x)|\rho_2(t,x)dx \\ \leqslant \int_{\mathbb{R}^3}\left(\int_{\mathbb{R}^3} |\mathcal{U}(x - T_t(y)) - \mathcal{U}(x-y)|\rho_2(t,x)dx\right)\rho_2^t(y)dy.\end{aligned}$$

Now we split the inner integral into three parts, corresponding to the domains $B(T_t(y),\epsilon_y^t)$, $B(T_t(y),\epsilon_y^t)$ and $B(y,\epsilon_y^t)^c \cap B(T_t(y),\epsilon_y^t)^c$, where $\epsilon_y^t = |T_t(y) - y|$. Observing that the Oseen tensor $\mathcal{U}$ satisfies that there exists $C > 0$ such that for all x in $\mathbb{R}^3 \setminus \{0\}$, $|\mathcal{U}(x)| \leqslant C\frac{1}{|x|}$, and using (19) we deduce from (38) that for any $t \geqslant 0$,

$$\begin{aligned}\int |u_1(t,x) - u_2(t,x)|\rho_2(t,x)dx \\ &\leqslant C\int\int_{B\left(T_t(y),\epsilon_y^t\right)}\left(\frac{1}{|x - T_t(y)|} + \frac{1}{|x-y|}\right)\rho_2(t,x)dx\rho_2^t(y)dy \\ &\quad + C\int\int_{B\left(y,\epsilon_y^t\right)}\left(\frac{1}{|x - T_t(y)|} + \frac{1}{|x-y|}\right)\rho_2(t,x)dx\rho_2^t(y)dy \\ &\quad + C\int \epsilon_y^t \int_{B\left(y,\epsilon_y^t\right)^c \cap B\left(T_t(y),\epsilon_y^t\right)^c}\left(\frac{1}{|x - T_t(y)|^2} + \frac{1}{|x-y|^2}\right)\rho_2(t,x)dx\rho_2^t(y)dy \\ &=: I_1 + I_2 + I_3.\end{aligned}$$

Regarding I_1 and I_2 we can proceed in the same way as in the proof of Proposition 3.5 and obtain

$$I_1 + I_2 \leqslant C(\|\rho_2\|_{L^3(\mathbb{R}^3)})Q(t).$$

For I_3 we distinguish two cases. First if $\epsilon_y^t = |y - T_t(y)| \geqslant 1$ we get

$$\int_{B\left(y,\epsilon_y^t\right)^c \cap B\left(T_t(y),\epsilon_y^t\right)^c}\left(\frac{1}{|x - T_t(y)|^2} + \frac{1}{|x-y|^2}\right)\rho_2(t,x)dx \leqslant \|\rho_2^t\|_1.$$

On the other hand, if $\epsilon_y^t = |y - T_t(y)| \leqslant 1$, then

$$\begin{aligned}
&\int_{B\left(y,\epsilon_y^t\right)^c \cap B\left(T_t(y),\epsilon_y^t\right)^c} \left(\frac{1}{|x-T_t(y)|^2} + \frac{1}{|x-y|^2}\right) \rho_2(t,x)dx \\
&\leqslant \int_{B(T_t(y),\epsilon_y^t)^c} \frac{1}{|x-T_t(y)|^2}\rho_2(t,x)dx + \int_{B\left(y,\epsilon_y^t\right)^c} \frac{1}{|x-y|^2}\rho_2(t,x)dx \\
&\leqslant \|\rho_2\|_1 + \int_{B(T_t(y),2)\setminus B\left(T_t(y),\epsilon_y^t\right)} \frac{1}{|x-T_t(y)|^2}\rho_2(t,x)dx \\
&+ \int_{B(y,2)\setminus B\left(y,\epsilon_y^t\right)} \frac{1}{|x-y|^2}\rho_2(t,x)dx \\
&\leqslant C(\|\rho_2\|_{L^1\cap L^3})(1 + |\log|T_t(y)-y||).
\end{aligned}$$

Gathering all the estimates we get

$$\begin{aligned}
&\int |u_1(t,x) - u_2(t,x)|\rho_2(t,x)dx \\
&\qquad\qquad \leqslant C(\|\rho_2\|_{L^1\cap L^3}) \int |T_t(y)-y|(1+\ln_-|T_t(y)-y|)\rho_2^t(y)dy.
\end{aligned}$$

Using the fact that $z \mapsto z(1+\ln_- z)$ is concave for $z \geqslant 0$ we get (42) and this concludes the proof of Lemma 4.1. □

We have for any $t \geqslant 0$,

$$Q(t) \leqslant Q(0) + C\left(\|\rho_i\|_{L^\infty(0,t,L^1\cap L^3)}\right)\int_0^t Q(s)(1+\ln_- Q(s))ds.$$

Thanks to the Osgood theorem, see Lemma 3.8 with $\eta(z) = z(1+\ln_-(z))$, we deduce (10). This concludes the proof of Theorem 2.3.

5. Proof of Theorem 2.1

The proof of existence can be done by a density argument using the well known results for the existence of a solution in the case of regular data, see [25] and [32], however we propose below a self-contained proof based on a fixed-point argument.

5.1. **Iterative scheme.** Let $p \geqslant 3$, $\rho_0 \in E_p$ and consider the sequence (u^n, ρ^n) where

$$u^n(t) \in \begin{cases} W^{2,p}\left(\mathbb{R}^3\right) & \text{if} \quad p > 3, \\ \dot{W}^{2,3}\left(\mathbb{R}^3\right) \cap \dot{W}^{1,3}\left(\mathbb{R}^3\right) \cap \bigcap\limits_{q\in(3,+\infty]} W^{1,q}\left(\mathbb{R}^3\right) & \text{if} \quad p = 3, \end{cases}$$

the unique solution to the Stokes equation

$$\begin{gathered}
-\Delta u^n + \nabla p^n = -\rho^n e_3,\ \operatorname{div}(u^n) = 0,\ \text{on } \mathbb{R}^3, \\
\lim_{|x|\to\infty} |u^n| = 0,
\end{gathered}$$

and ρ^{n+1} the unique solution to the transport equation

$$\begin{cases} \partial_t\rho^{n+1} + \operatorname{div}\left(\rho^{n+1}u^n\right) &= 0,\ \text{on } \mathbb{R}^3, \\ \rho^{n+1}(0,\cdot) &= \rho_0, \end{cases}$$

with $\rho^0 = \rho_0$. Since u^n is divergence free and the associated flow X^n is well defined, classical considerations for the transport equation ensure that

$$\rho^n \in C\left([0,+\infty), L^1\left(\mathbb{R}^3\right) \cap L^p\left(\mathbb{R}^3\right)\right)$$

for each n and we have for any t,

$$\left\|\rho^{n+1}(t)\right\|_{L^1(\mathbb{R}^3)} = \|\rho_0\|_{L^1(\mathbb{R}^3)},\ \left\|\rho^{n+1}(t)\right\|_{L^p(\mathbb{R}^3)} = \|\rho_0\|_{L^p(\mathbb{R}^3)}, \tag{43}$$

Hence, we get the following uniform bounds of the velocity:

$$\|u^n(t)\|_{W^{2,p}(\mathbb{R}^3)} \leqslant C\left\|\rho^n(t)\right\|_{L^1(\mathbb{R}^3)\cap L^p(\mathbb{R}^3)} \leqslant C\|\rho_0\|_{L^1(\mathbb{R}^3)\cap L^p(\mathbb{R}^3)} \tag{44}$$

in the case where $p > 3$ and

$$\begin{aligned}
&\operatorname{Log}-\operatorname{Lip}(u^n(t)) + \|\nabla u^n(t)\|_{W^{1,3}(\mathbb{R}^3)} + \|u^n(t)\|_{W^{1,q}(\mathbb{R}^3)} \\
&\qquad\qquad \leqslant C\left\|\rho^n(t)\right\|_{L^1(\mathbb{R}^3)\cap L^3(\mathbb{R}^3)} \leqslant C\|\rho_0\|_{L^1(\mathbb{R}^3)\cap L^3(\mathbb{R}^3)},
\end{aligned} \tag{45}$$

in the case $p = 3$ with $q \in (3, +\infty]$. Moreover for $p \geqslant 3$, we have, for all $0 \leqslant t \leqslant t' \leqslant T$,

$$W_1\left(\rho^{n+1}(t), \rho^{n+1}(t')\right) \leqslant \int_{\mathbb{R}^3} |X^n(t', 0, x) - X^n(t, 0, x)| \, \rho_0(dx) \leqslant (t' - t)\|u^n\|_{L^\infty(0,T;L^\infty(\mathbb{R}^3))}\|\rho_0\|_{L^1(\mathbb{R}^3)}. \tag{46}$$

This shows that

$$\rho^n \in C\left([0,T], \mathcal{P}\left(\mathbb{R}^3\right) \cap L^1\left(\mathbb{R}^3\right) \cap L^p\left(\mathbb{R}^3\right)\right) \text{ uniformly in n for any } T > 0.$$

Using the same arguments as in (38), We emphasize the following estimates for any compact set K of $\mathbb{R}^3$

$$\|u^n(t) - u^n(t')\|_{W^{1,\infty}(K)} \leqslant C_K W_1\left(\rho^n(t), \rho^n(t')\right), \text{ if } p > 3, \tag{47}$$

$$\|u^n(t) - u^n(t')\|_{L^\infty(K)} \leqslant C_K W_1\left(\rho^n(t), \rho^n(t')\right), \text{ if } p = 3. \tag{48}$$

5.2. **Convergence of $(\rho^n)_n$.** We introduce the following space for $M > 0$

$$B_{T,M} = \left\{ \rho \in C\left([0,T], \mathcal{P}\left(\mathbb{R}^3\right)\right), \quad \sup_{[0,T]} W_1(\rho(t), \rho_0) \leqslant M \right\}.$$

which is complete for the metric $d(\rho_1, \rho_2) := \sup_{[0,T]} W_1(\rho_1(t), \rho_2(t))$.

Since $\rho^{n+1}(t) := X^n(t, 0, \cdot)\#\rho_0$ we have

$$W_1\left(\rho^n(t), \rho_0\right) \leqslant \int_{\mathbb{R}} |X^n(t, 0, x) - x| \rho_0(dy) \leqslant T\|\rho_0\|_{L^1}\|u^n\|_{L^\infty(0,T;L^\infty)},$$

which shows that $(\rho_n)_n$ lies in $B_{T,M}$ for an adequate choice of $M > 0$. We aim to show that (ρ_n) is a Cauchy sequence in $B_{T,M}$ for $T > 0$ small enough. We present below the argument by distinguishing the case $p = 3$ from the case $p > 3$.

Case where $p > 3$. For $p > 3$, the stability estimates (37) ensure that

$$W_1\left(\rho^n(t), \rho^{n+1}(t)\right) \leqslant \left(\int_0^t \int_{\mathbb{R}^3} \left|u^{n-1}(s,x) - u^n(s,x)\right| \rho^n(s,x) dx ds \right) e^{M_n t},$$

with

$$M_n = \left(\sup_{0 \leqslant s \leqslant t} \mathrm{Lip}(u^n(s)) \right).$$

On the other hand, performing an estimate as in (39) yields

$$\int_{\mathbb{R}^3} \left|u^{n-1}(s,x) - u^n(s,x)\right| \rho^n(s,x) dx \leqslant C\left(\|\rho^n\|_{L^1(\mathbb{R}^3) \cap L^p(\mathbb{R}^3)}\right) W_1\left(\rho^{n-1}(s), \rho^n(s)\right).$$

Hence for all $t \in [0,T]$ we get using (43) and $M_n = \sup_{0 \leqslant s \leqslant T} \mathrm{Lip}(u^n(s)) \leqslant M$ thanks to (44)

$$\sup_{t \in [0,T]} W_1\left(\rho^n, \rho^{n+1}\right) \leqslant CTe^{MT} \sup_{t \in [0,T]} W_1\left(\rho^n, \rho^{n-1}\right).$$

This shows that for $T > 0$ small enough, ρ_n is a Cauchy sequence.

Case where $p = 3$. For $p = 3$ we use estimates (41) to get for all $n, k \in \mathbb{N}$

$$W_1\left(\rho^{n+k+1}(t), \rho^{k+1}(t)\right) \leqslant C^{n,k} \int_0^t \eta\left(W_1\left(\rho^{n+k+1}(s), \rho^{k+1}(s)\right)\right) ds + \int_0^t \int_{\mathbb{R}^3} \left|u^{n+k}(s,x) - u^k(s,x)\right| \rho^{n+k}(s,x) dx ds, \tag{49}$$

with $\eta(z) = z(1 + \ln_-(z))$ for $z \geqslant 0$ and

$$C^{n,k} = \sup_{s \in [0,T]} \mathrm{Log} - \mathrm{Lip}\left(u^{n+k}(s)\right) \leqslant C \sup_{s \in [0,T]} \left\|\rho^{n+k}(s)\right\|_{L^1(\mathbb{R}^3) \cap L^3(\mathbb{R}^3)} \leqslant C,$$

thanks to (23) and the uniform bounds on $(\rho^n)_n$.

On the one hand, using the uniform bounds of $(u^n)_n$ in $C([0,T], L^\infty)$ and $(\rho_n)_n$ in $C([0,T], L^1)$ and the fact that $\eta(z) \leqslant \max(z, 1)$ we have from (49)

$$\sup_{0 \leqslant s \leqslant t} W_1\left(\rho^{n+k+1}(t), \rho^{k+1}(t)\right) \leqslant Ct\left(1 + \sup_{0 \leqslant s \leqslant t} W_1\left(\rho^{n+k+1}(t), \rho^{k+1}(t)\right)\right) + tC,$$

which shows that, for t small enough, the sequence $(\sup_{0 \leqslant s \leqslant t} W_1(\rho^{n+k}(t), \rho^k(t)))_{n,k}$ is uniformly bounded.

On the other hand, thanks to Lemma 4.1 we have

$$\int_0^t \int_{\mathbb{R}^3} \left|u^{n+k}(s,x) - u^k(s,x)\right| \rho^{n+k}(s,x) dx ds \leqslant C \int_0^t \eta\left(W_1\left(\rho^{n+k}(s), \rho^k(s)\right)\right) ds, \tag{50}$$

where we used again (43), (44) to get a constant independent of n, k. Hence gathering inequalities (49) and (50) and setting

$$f_k(t) := \sup_n \sup_{0 \leqslant s \leqslant t} W_1\left(\rho^{n+k}(s), \rho^k(s)\right),$$

we get for all $T \geqslant 0$

$$f_{k+1}(T) \leqslant C \int_0^T \eta\left(f_{k+1}(s)\right) ds + C \int_0^T \eta\left(f_k(s)\right) ds,$$

where we used the fact that $z \mapsto \eta(z)$ is a non-decreasing function. By setting $\widetilde{f}(t) := \limsup_{k \to \infty} f_k(t)$ we have

$$\widetilde{f}(T) \leqslant 2C \int_0^T \eta\left(\widetilde{f}(s)\right) ds.$$

We conclude thanks to Lemma 3.8 that $\widetilde{f} = 0$ a.e on $[0,T]$, which shows that ρ^n is a Cauchy sequence.

Conclusion. Hence for $p \geqslant 3$, there exists a limit measure $\rho \in B_{T,M} \subset C([0,T], \mathcal{P}(\mathbb{R}^3))$ such that

$$\sup_{t \in [0,T]} W_1(\rho^n, \rho) \to 0.$$

5.3. **Convergence of $(u^n)_n$ and $(X^n)_n$.** The second step is to extract a converging subsequence of $(u^n)_n$ by distinguishing again the case where $p > 3$ from the case where $p = 3$.

Case where $p > 3$. Since for each compact set K of $\mathbb{R}^3$ the sequence $t \mapsto u^n(t)$ is equicontinuous in $W^{1,\infty}(K)$ thanks to (47), (46) and $x \mapsto u^n(t,x)$ relatively compact in $C^1(K)$ (using Ascoli with the equicontinuity of $x \mapsto u^n(t,x)$ in $C^1(K)$), we get using again Ascoli the existence of $u \in C([0,T], C^1(\mathbb{R}^3))$ such that $u^n \to u$ in $C([0,T], C^1(K))$ up to a subsequence for each compact K.

Regarding the flow X^n, one can show that for each $0 \leqslant s \leqslant T$, $X^n(\cdot, s, \cdot)$ is uniformly bounded in $C([0,T], C^1(K))$ on each compact set $K \in \mathbb{R}^3$, equicontinuous in $C([0,T], C^1(\mathbb{R}^3))$ and that for each $t \in [0,T]$, $X^n(t,s,\cdot)$ is relatively compact in $C^1(K)$. Indeed we have the following bounds for each $x, y \in \mathbb{R}^3$, $t, t' \in [0,T]$, $|t - t'| < 1$.

$$|X^n(t,s,x)| \leqslant |x| + |t-s| \|u^n\|_{C(0,T;C(\mathbb{R}^3))}, \ |\nabla X^n(t,s,x)| \leqslant e^{L(t-s)}, \tag{51}$$

$$|\nabla X^n(t,s,x) - \nabla X^n(t,s,y)| \leqslant |x-y|^\mu e^{L|t-s|}, \tag{52}$$

$$\|X^n(t,s,\cdot) - X^n(t',s,\cdot)\|_{C^1(\mathbb{R}^3)} \leqslant M e^{LT} |t-t'|^\mu. \tag{53}$$

From (53) we get that $t \mapsto X^n(t,s,\cdot)$ is equicontinuous with values in $C^{1,\mu}$,(51) and (52) ensure that for each t, $X^n(t,s,\cdot)$ is relatively compact in $C^1(K)$. Since X^n is uniformly bounded in $C([0,T], C^{1,\mu}(K))$ thanks to (51), then using the Ascoli theorem, there exists $X(\cdot,s,\cdot) \in C([0,T], C^{1,\mu}(\mathbb{R}^3))$ such that $X^n(\cdot,s,\cdot) \to X(\cdot,s,\cdot)$ in $C([0,T], C^1(K))$ for each compact K. In particular passing in the limit we have for all $s, t \in [0,T]$, $X(t,s,\cdot) \circ X(s,t,\cdot) = Id$, and using the convergence of u^n to u in $C([0,T], C^1(K))$ for each compact K we get that X satisfies (7).

Case where $p = 3$. We proceed analogously using (48) and show that there exists $u \in C([0,T], C(\mathbb{R}^3))$ such that for each compact set K we have $u^n \to u$ in $C([0,T]; C(K))$.

Regarding the flow X^n, $X^n(\cdot,s,\cdot) - Id$ is uniformly bounded in $C([0,T], C(\mathbb{R}^3))$ and in particular in $C([0,T], C(K))$ for each compact set. Now, let $x, y \in \mathbb{R}^3$, $|x-y| \leqslant 1/2$ and T^n the maximal time such that $|X^n(t,s,x) - X^n(t,s,y)| < 3/4$ for $t, s \in [0,T]$, we have

$$\left|X^n(t,s,x) - X^n(t,s,y)\right| \leqslant |x-y| + \left(\sup_{\tau \in [0,T]} \mathrm{Log} - \mathrm{Lip}\left(u^n(\tau)\right)\right) \times \int_s^t \left|X^n(t,s,x) - X^n(t,s,y)\right| \left(1 + \ln_-\left|X^n(t,s,x) - X^n(t,s,y)\right|\right),$$

where $(\sup_{\tau \in [0,T]} \mathrm{Log} - \mathrm{Lip}(u^n(\tau)))$ is uniformly bounded thanks to (45). Using Lemma 3.8 with $\eta(z) := z(1 + \ln_-(z))$, we get for some constant $\bar{C}$ for any $t \leqslant T^n$, $|x-y| \leqslant 1/2$

$$|X^n(t,s,x) - X^n(t,s,y)| \leqslant \bar{C} |x-y|^{e^{-CT}}, \tag{54}$$

which shows that the maximal time T^n can be taken independent of n and $T^n = T$ for T small enough. hence, $X^n(t,s,\cdot)$ is relatively compact in $C(K)$ for each $t,s \in [0,T]$. Moreover

$$\|X^n(t,s,\cdot) - X^n(t',s,\cdot)\|_{C(K)} \leqslant |t-t'| \|u^n\|_{C(0,T;L^\infty(\mathbb{R}^3))},$$

which ensures that $t \mapsto X^n(t,s,\cdot)$ is equicontinuous for each $s \in [0,T]$. Using again the Ascoli theorem this allows us to extract a converging subsequence in $C([0,T],C(K))$. This allows us to construct $X \in C([0,T],C(\mathbb{R}^3))$ and by passing in the limit in (54) pointwisely we get for all $x,y \in \mathbb{R}^3$, for all t,s in $[0,T]$,

$$|X(t,s,x) - X(t,s,y)| \leqslant \bar{C}|x-y|^{e^{-CT}},$$

and analogously to the case $p > 3$ we have for $s,t \in [0,T]$, $X(t,s,\cdot) \circ X(s,t,\cdot) = Id$.

5.4. **Existence and uniqueness of the solution.** Convergence of ρ^n and u^n (up to a subsequence) allows to pass in the limit in both the Stokes and transport equations and show that (u,ρ) satisfies the transport-Stokes system weakly. Moreover, using the fact that X^n satisfies

$$\rho^{n+1}(t,\cdot) = X^n(t,0,\cdot)\#\rho_0,$$

one can pass in the limit in both sides thanks to the strong convergence of X^n up to a subsequence and the convergence of ρ^n using the Wasserstein metric. Indeed, we get for all $\psi \in C_b(\mathbb{R}^3)$

$$\int \psi(x)\rho(t,x)dx = \int \psi(X(0,t,x))\rho_0(x)dx,$$

which means

$$\rho(t,\cdot) = X(t,0,\cdot)\#\rho_0,$$

and since $X \in C([0,T],C(\mathbb{R}^3))$ we recover that $\rho \in C([0,T],L^p(\mathbb{R}^3)\cap L^1(\mathbb{R}^3))$. From this it follows that $u \in C([0,T],W^{2,p}(\mathbb{R}^3))$ with the bounds (3) (resp. $\nabla u \in C([0,T],W^{1,3}(\mathbb{R}^3))$, $u \in C([0,T],W^{1,q}(\mathbb{R}^3))$ for $q \in]3,+\infty]$ with the bounds (4)).

Global in time existence is ensured thanks to the uniform bounds of $\rho(t)$ in $L^p(\mathbb{R}^3)\cap L^1(\mathbb{R}^3)$ while uniqueness is ensured thanks to Theorem 2.3. This concludes the proof of Theorem 2.1.

6. Proof of Proposition 2.6

This section is devoted to the proof of Proposition 2.6. In the course of the proof we shall use a technical lemma, see Lemma 6.2, which is proved in the next section.

6.1. **A first few basic estimates.** We gather below some useful estimates. First, by (7), for all x and y in $\mathbb{R}^3$,

$$|x-y|e^{-\int_0^t \mathrm{Lip}(u(s,\cdot))ds} \leqslant |X(t,x)-X(t,y)| \leqslant |x-y|e^{\int_0^t \mathrm{Lip}(u(s,\cdot))ds}. \tag{55}$$

Thus, for $T > 0$ small enough, this implies that there exists $\lambda \in (1,3/2]$ such that

$$\frac{1}{\lambda} \leqslant \frac{|X(t,x)-X(t,y)}{|x-y|} \leqslant \lambda,\ \forall\ x \neq y,\ t \in [0,T]. \tag{56}$$

Next, by splitting the integral into two parts, distinguishing the cases where $|x-z| \leqslant 1$ and where $|x-z| > 1$, and using Hölder's inequality for the first case with the observation that $p > 3$, we obtain the existence of $L = L(p) > 0$ such that for all $0 \leqslant s \leqslant 2$,

$$\sup_{x\in\mathbb{R}^3} \int \frac{\rho_0(dz)}{|x-z|^s} \leqslant L\|\rho_0\|_{L^1\cap L^p}. \tag{57}$$

Finally, from the definition of the Oseen tensor in (17) we deduce the following property.

Lemma 6.1. *There exists $K > 0$ such that for all x in $\mathbb{R}^3\setminus\{0\}$ and all multi-index $\alpha \in \mathbb{N}^3$*

$$|\partial^\alpha \mathcal{U}(x)| \leqslant \frac{K^{|\alpha|}|\alpha|!}{|x|^{1+|\alpha|}}. \tag{58}$$

Proof. Let $n \geqslant 1$ and $\alpha \in \mathbb{N}^3$ a multi-index such that $|\alpha| = n$. We consider first the term $u(x) := \frac{1}{|x|}$ in the Oseen tensor. Since

$$\partial_{x_i}\frac{1}{|x|^p} = -p\frac{x_i}{|x|^{p+2}}, \tag{59}$$

one can show by induction that for all $|\alpha| = n$ there exists polynomials P_k^α, $k = \lceil \frac{n}{2} \rceil, \cdots, n$ such that

$$\partial^\alpha u(x) = \sum_{k=\lceil \frac{n}{2}\rceil}^{n} \frac{P_k^\alpha(x)}{|x|^{1+2k}}, \tag{60}$$

where P_k^α is a sum of monomials in x_1, x_2, x_3 such that each monomial is of degree $-n+2k \geqslant 0$ and $\lceil \frac{n}{2} \rceil$ denotes the ceiling function of $\frac{n}{2}$.

Indeed the induction formula is satisfied for $n = 1$ as a consequence of (59) with $p = 1$. Now we assume that (60) holds true up to n, and we observe that, for any $1 \leqslant i \leqslant 3$ and for any $\alpha \in \mathbb{N}^3$ with $|\alpha| = n$, by the induction assumption (60), Leibniz' rule and (59),

$$\begin{aligned}\partial_i \partial^\alpha u(x) &= -\sum_{k=\lceil \frac{n}{2} \rceil}^{n} (1+2k) \frac{x_i P_k^\alpha(x)}{|x|^{3+2k}} + \sum_{k=\lceil \frac{n}{2} \rceil}^{n} \frac{\partial_i P_k^\alpha(x)}{|x|^{1+2k}} \\ &= \frac{\partial_i P^\alpha_{\lceil \frac{n}{2} \rceil}(x)}{|x|^{1+2\lceil \frac{n}{2} \rceil}} + \sum_{k=\lceil \frac{n}{2} \rceil+1}^{n} \frac{\partial_i P_k^\alpha(x) - (2k-1) x_i P_{k-1}^\alpha(x)}{|x|^{1+2k}} - (1+2n) \frac{x_i P_n^\alpha(x)}{|x|^{3+2n}}.\end{aligned}$$

Since $\lceil \frac{n}{2} \rceil + 1 = \lceil \frac{n+1}{2} \rceil$ for $n \geqslant 0$, all the terms in (61) except the first one correspond to a term of the form $\frac{P_k^\beta}{|x|^{1+2k}}$ with $\beta = e_i + \alpha$ and $k \in \{\lceil \frac{n+1}{2} \rceil, \dots, n+1\}$. For the first term we distinguish two cases

- If $n = 2p$, the polynomial $P^\alpha_{\lceil \frac{n}{2} \rceil}$ is of degree $-n + 2\lceil \frac{n}{2} \rceil = -n + 2p = 0$ hence $\partial_i P^\alpha_{\lceil \frac{n}{2} \rceil} = 0$.
- If $n = 2p+1$, then $\lceil \frac{n}{2} \rceil = p+1 = \lceil \frac{2p+2}{2} \rceil = \lceil \frac{n+1}{2} \rceil$ and hence the polynomial $\partial_i P^\alpha_{\lceil \frac{n}{2} \rceil}$ corresponds to a term of the form P_k^β with $k = \lceil \frac{n+1}{2} \rceil$.

Now if we set D_n the maximal number of monomials appearing in (60) for all $|\alpha| = n$ we have using (61)

$$D_{n+1} \leqslant D_n + 2D_n = 3D_n \leqslant 3^n D_1.$$

If we set C_n the largest coefficient (in absolute value) appearing in (60) for all $\alpha \in \mathbb{N}^3$ with $|\alpha| = n$, we have, by using (61), that

$$C_{n+1} \leqslant (1+2n) C_n \leqslant \prod_{k=1}^{n} (2k+1) C_1.$$

We observe that $C_1 = 1$, that $D_1 = 1$ and that

$$|\partial^\alpha \frac{1}{|x|}| \leqslant \frac{D_n C_n}{|x|^{1+n}} \leqslant \frac{3^n 2^{3n+2} (n!)}{|x|^{1+n}},$$

with $n = |\alpha|$. Above we used that

$$(2n+1)! = \left(\prod_{k=1}^{n} (2k+1) \right) \left(\prod_{k=1}^{n} (2k) \right) = 2^n n! \left(\prod_{k=1}^{n} (2k+1) \right),$$

and

$$(2n+1)! = (2n+1)(2n)! \leqslant n(2n+1) 2^{n+1} (n!)^2 \leqslant 2^{3n+1} 2^{n+1} (n!)^2.$$

For the second term in the Oseen tensor $\frac{x_i x_j}{|x|^3}$ one can show analogously that the derivatives of $u(x) = \frac{1}{|x|^3}$ are of the form

$$\partial^\alpha u(x) = \sum_{k=\lceil \frac{n}{2} \rceil}^{n} \frac{P_k^\alpha(x)}{|x|^{2k+3}},$$

where in P_k^α is a sum of monomials of degree $-n+2k$. Using the same arguments as above, we get that for $\alpha \in \mathbb{N}^3$ with $n = |\alpha|$

$$\left| \partial^\alpha \frac{1}{|x|^3} \right| \leqslant \frac{3^n 2^{3n+5}}{|x|^{3+n}} (n+1)! \leqslant \frac{3^{11n}}{|x|^{3+n}} n!.$$

we conclude by using Leibniz formula

$$\begin{aligned}\left| \partial^\alpha \frac{x_i x_j}{|x|^3} \right| &= \sum_{\beta+\gamma=\alpha} \binom{\beta}{\alpha} \partial^\beta \left(\frac{1}{|x|^3} \right) \partial^\gamma (x_i x_j) \\ &\leqslant \sum_{|\alpha|-2 \leqslant |\beta| \leqslant |\alpha|} \binom{\beta}{\alpha} \frac{3^{11|\beta|}}{|x|^{3+|\beta|}} |\beta|! 2 |x|^{2-|\alpha|+|\beta|} \\ &\leqslant \frac{3^{13|\alpha|}}{|x|^{1+|\alpha|}} |\alpha|!.\end{aligned}$$

where we used $\sum_{0 \leqslant |\beta| \leqslant |\alpha|} \binom{\beta}{\alpha} = 2^{|\alpha|}$. This concludes the proof of Lemma 6.1. □

6.2. **The case where $n = 1$.** From (7), we deduce that

$$\|\partial_t X(t,\cdot)\|_\infty \leqslant \|u\|_\infty \leqslant C\|\rho_0\|_{L^1(\mathbb{R}^3)\cap L^p(\mathbb{R}^3)}, \tag{61}$$

$$\|\nabla\partial_t X(t,\cdot)\|_\infty \leqslant \|\nabla u\|_\infty\|\nabla X\|_\infty \leqslant C\|\rho_0\|_{L^1(\mathbb{R}^3)\cap L^p(\mathbb{R}^3)}\lambda, \tag{62}$$

and for any $x \neq y$ we have

$$\begin{aligned}&\big|\nabla\partial_t X(t,x) - \nabla\partial_t X(t,y)\big| \\ &\qquad\leqslant [\nabla u]_{0,\mu}|X(t,x)-X(t,y)|^\mu\|\nabla X\|_\infty + |\nabla X(t,x)-\nabla X(t,y)|\|\nabla u\|_\infty.\end{aligned}$$

Moreover, we recall that the flow X is Lipschitz thanks to (56). Therefore, we get for any $x \neq y$

$$\begin{aligned}&\big|\nabla\partial_t X(t,x) - \nabla\partial_t X(t,y)\big| \\ &\qquad\leqslant [\nabla u]_{0,\mu}\lambda^\mu\|\nabla X\|_\infty\,|x-y|^\mu + \|\nabla u\|_\infty\int_0^t\big|\nabla\partial_s X(s,x) - \nabla\partial_s X(s,y)\big|ds.\end{aligned}$$

Hence by Gronwall lemma, we arrive at

$$[\nabla\partial_t X]_{0,\mu} \leqslant C\|u\|_{2,p}\lambda^\mu\|\nabla X\|_\infty e^{\|\nabla u\|_\infty t}.$$

This entails that the induction assumption is satisfied for $n = 1$ with

$$C_0 = C_0\left(\|\rho_0\|_{L^1(\mathbb{R}^3)\,\cap\, L^p(\mathbb{R}^3)}, \lambda, T, \mu\right)$$

such that

$$\|\partial_t X(t,\cdot)\|_{1,\mu} \leqslant \frac{C_0}{2}, \tag{63}$$

where we used (61) and (62).

6.3. **Beginning of the iteration.** Assume that (11) is satisfied up to $n \in \mathbb{N}^*$, we need to prove by induction the bound (11). Hence we split the proof into three parts corresponding to the L^∞ estimate $\|\partial_t^{n+1}X(t,\cdot)\|_\infty$, the Lipschitz estimate $\|\nabla\partial_t^{n+1}X(t,\cdot)\|_\infty$ and the Hölder estimate $[\nabla\partial_t^{n+1}X(t,\cdot)]_{0,\mu}$.

From (7) and (21), we deduce the key formula

$$\partial_t X(t,x) = \int \mathcal{U}_3(X(t,x)-X(t,y))\rho_0(y)dy, \tag{64}$$

where

$$\mathcal{U}_3(x) := -\mathcal{U}(x)e_3.$$

6.4. L^∞ **Estimates.** By (64) and the Multivariate Faà di Bruno formula (15),

$$\begin{aligned}&\partial_t^{n+1}X(t,x) = \partial_t^n\partial_t X(t,x)\\ &= n!\sum_{1\leqslant|\alpha|\leqslant n}\int\big(\partial^\alpha\mathcal{U}_3(X(t,x)-X(t,z))\big)\sum_{s=1}^n\sum_{P_s(n,\alpha)}\prod_{j=1}^s\frac{\partial_t^{l_j}\left(X(t,x)-X(t,z)\right)^{k_j}}{(k_j!)\,(l_j!)^{|k_j|}}\rho_0(dz).\end{aligned}$$

Since the integers l_j in the formula above satisfy $l_j \leqslant n$, we get by using the (Lipschitz part of the) induction hypothesis (11) and (58),

$$\begin{aligned}\big|\partial_t^{n+1}X(t,x)\big| \leqslant n!\sum_{1\leqslant|\alpha|\leqslant n}&\int_{\mathbb{R}^3}\frac{K^{|\alpha|}|\alpha|!}{|X(t,x)-X(t,z)|^{1+|\alpha|}}\\ &\times\sum_{s=1}^n\sum_{P_s(n,\alpha)}\prod_{j=1}^s\frac{\left|(-1)^{l_j-1}\,(l_j)!C_0^{l_j}C_1^{l_j-1}\binom{1/2}{l_j}\right|^{|k_j|}|x-z|^{|k_j|}}{(k_j!)\,(l_j!)^{|k_j|}}\rho_0(dz),\end{aligned}$$

and therefore

$$\begin{aligned}\big|\partial_t^{n+1}X(t,x)\big| \leqslant n!(-1)^nC_0^nC_1^n\sum_{1\leqslant|\alpha|\leqslant n}&K^{|\alpha|}|\alpha|!(-1)^{|\alpha|}C_1^{-|\alpha|}\\ &\times\left(\int_{\mathbb{R}^3}\frac{|x-z|^{|\alpha|}}{|X(t,x)-X(t,z)|^{1+|\alpha|}}\rho_0(dz)\right)\sum_{s=1}^n\sum_{P_s(n,\alpha)}\prod_{j=1}^s\frac{\binom{1/2}{l_j}^{|k_j|}}{k_j!},\end{aligned}$$

by using the definition of $P_s(n,\alpha)$. Then, by (56) and (57), we deduce that

$$\left|\partial_t^{n+1}X(t,x)\right| \leqslant n!(-1)^n C_0^n C_1^n \lambda L\|\rho_0\| \sum_{1\leqslant|\alpha|\leqslant n}|\alpha|!(-1)^{|\alpha|}\left(KC_1^{-1}\lambda\right)^{|\alpha|}\sum_{s=1}^{n}\sum_{P_s(n,\alpha)}\prod_{j=1}^{s}\frac{\binom{1/2}{l_j}^{|k_j|}}{k_j!}.$$

Hence, considering $C_0>0$ and $C_1>0$ such that $KC_1^{-1}\lambda<1$ and $L\|\rho_0\|\lambda<C_0/2$, and using that, according to [7, Lemma 3.3], there holds:

$$\sum_{1\leqslant|\alpha|\leqslant n}|\alpha|!(-1)^{|\alpha|}\sum_{s=1}^{n}\sum_{P_s(n,\alpha)}\prod_{j=1}^{s}\frac{\binom{1/2}{l_j}^{|k_j|}}{k_j!}=2(n+1)\binom{1/2}{n+1}, \tag{65}$$

we get that

$$\left|\partial_t^{n+1}X(t,x)\right|\leqslant(n+1)!(-1)^n C_0^{n+1}C_1^n\binom{1/2}{n+1}.$$

6.5. **Lipschitz estimates.** First, from (64) we deduce, by derivation in space, that

$$\partial_t\nabla X(t,x)=\int_{\mathbb{R}^3}\nabla\mathcal{U}_3(X(t,x)-X(t,z))\nabla X(t,x)\rho_0(dz). \tag{66}$$

Moreover, by applying ∂_t^n and applying the Leibniz formula, we arrive at

$$\partial_t^{n+1}\nabla X(t,x)=\sum_{k=0}^{n}\binom{n}{k}\int_{\mathbb{R}^3}\partial_t^k\big(\nabla\mathcal{U}_3(X(t,x)-X(t,z))\big)\partial_t^{n-k}\nabla X(t,x)\rho_0(dz).$$

A subtlety here is that it is necessary to distinguish between the case where $0\leqslant k<n$ and the case where $k=n$.

First, for $0\leqslant k<n$, it follows from the induction hypothesis (11) that

$$\left|\partial_t^{n-k}\nabla X(t,x)\right|\leqslant(-1)^{n-k-1}(n-k)!\binom{1/2}{n-k}C_0^{n-k}C_1^{n-k-1}. \tag{67}$$

Second using for all $0\leqslant k\leqslant n$, by the multivariate Faà di Bruno formula (15),

$$\partial_t^k\big(\nabla\mathcal{U}_3(X(t,x)-X(t,z))\big) = k!\sum_{1\leqslant|\alpha|\leqslant n}\left(\partial^\alpha\nabla\mathcal{U}_3\right)(X(t,x)-X(t,z))\times\sum_{s=1}^{n}\sum_{P_s(n,\alpha)}\prod_{j=1}^{s}\frac{\partial_t^{l_j}(X(t,x)-X(t,z))^{k_j}}{(k_j!)\,(l_j!)^{|k_j|}}.$$

Therefore, for $0\leqslant k<n$, we get by (58) and the induction assumption (11), which is assumed to be satisfied up to $n\in\mathbb{N}^*$,

$$\begin{aligned}\int_{\mathbb{R}^3}\left|\partial_t^k\big(\nabla\mathcal{U}_3(X(t,x)-X(t,z))\big)\right|\rho_0(dz) &\leqslant k!\sum_{1\leqslant|\alpha|\leqslant k}\int_{\mathbb{R}^3}\frac{K^{|\alpha|+1}(|\alpha|+1)!}{|X(t,x)-X(t,z)|^{2+|\alpha|}}\\ &\quad\times\sum_{s=1}^{k}\sum_{P_s(n,\alpha)}\prod_{j=1}^{s}\frac{\left|(-1)^{l_j-1}(l_j)!C_0^{l_j}C_1^{l_j-1}\binom{1/2}{l_j}\right|^{|k_j|}|x-z|^{|k_j|}}{(k_j!)\,(l_j!)^{|k_j|}}\rho_0(dz)\\ &\leqslant(-1)^k k!C_0^kC_1^k\sum_{1\leqslant|\alpha|\leqslant k}C_1^{-|\alpha|}K^{1+|\alpha|}(1+|\alpha|)\lambda^{2+|\alpha|}\left(\int_{\mathbb{R}^3}\frac{\rho_0(dz)}{|x-z|^2}\right)\\ &\quad\times(-1)^{|\alpha|}|\alpha|!\sum_{s=1}^{k}\sum_{P_s(k,\alpha)}\prod_{j=1}^{s}\frac{\binom{1/2}{l_j}^{|k_j|}}{(k_j!)},\end{aligned}$$

by (56). Therefore,

$$\begin{aligned}\int_{\mathbb{R}^3} \left|\partial_t^k\big(\nabla\mathcal{U}_3(X(t,x)-X(t,z))\big)\right|\rho_0(dz)&\\ \leqslant (-1)^k k! C_0^k C_1^k \sum_{1\leqslant|\alpha|\leqslant k} \left(2KL\|\rho_0\|\lambda^2\right)\left(2C_1^{-1}K\lambda\right)^{|\alpha|}(-1)^{|\alpha|}|\alpha|!&\\ \sum_{s=1}^{k}\sum_{P_s(k,\alpha)}\prod_{j=1}^{s}\frac{\binom{1/2}{l_j}^{|k_j|}}{(k_j!)}&\\ \leqslant (-1)^k(k+1)!C_0^{k+1}C_1^{k+1}/4\binom{1/2}{k+1},&\end{aligned}$$

where we used (65) and assumed that $2C_1^{-1}K\lambda<1$ and $2KL\|\rho_0\|\lambda^2<\frac{C_0}{2}\frac{C_1}{4}$.

We treat the case $n=k$ slightly differently by assuming that $2KL\|\rho_0\|\lambda^2 < \frac{C_0}{2}\frac{1}{4}\frac{1}{\|\nabla X\|_\infty}$ instead. Thus,

$$\int_{\mathbb{R}^3}\left|\partial_t^n\big(\nabla\mathcal{U}_3(X(t,x)-X(t,z))\big)\right|\rho_0(dz)\leqslant(-1)^n(n+1)!C_0^{n+1}C_1^n\frac{1}{4\|\nabla X\|_\infty}\binom{1/2}{n+1}.$$

Gathering the estimates we get

$$\begin{aligned}\left|\partial_t^{n+1}\nabla X(t,x)\right|&\leqslant\sum_{k=0}^{n}\binom{n}{k}(-1)^{n-k-1}(n-k)!\binom{1/2}{n-k}C_0^{n-k}C_1^{n-k-1}\\ &\quad\times(-1)^k(k+1)!C_0^{k+1}\frac{C_1^{k+1}}{4}\binom{1/2}{k+1}\\ &\leqslant n!C_1^nC_0^{n+1}\sum_{k=0}^{n}(k+1)(-1)^{n-k-1}\binom{1/2}{n-k}(-1)^k\frac{1}{4}\binom{1/2}{k+1}\\ &\leqslant(n+1)!C_1^nC_0^{n+1}(-1)^n\binom{1/2}{n+1},\end{aligned}$$

where we used [7, Lemma 4.2] for $r=n$ to get

$$\sum_{k=0}^{n}(k+1)(-1)^k\binom{1/2}{k+1}(-1)^{n-k-1}\binom{1/2}{n-k}\leqslant 4(n+1)(-1)^n\binom{1/2}{n+1}. \tag{68}$$

Indeed we emphasize that $(-1)^n\binom{1/2}{n+1}\geqslant 0$ which allows us to bound the sum on $m=0\dots n$ and $r=n$ by the double sum on $m,r=0\cdots n$ in [7, Lemma 4.2].

6.6. **Hölder estimates.** By (66) and Leibniz' rule,

$$\begin{aligned}\partial_t^{n+1}\big(\nabla X(t,x)-\nabla X(t,y)\big)&\\ =\partial_t^n\int_{\mathbb{R}^3}\big[\nabla\mathcal{U}_3\big(X(t,x)-X(t,z)\big)-\nabla\mathcal{U}_3\big(X(t,y)-X(t,z)\big)\big]\nabla X(t,x)\rho_0(dz)&\\ +\partial_t^n\int_{\mathbb{R}^3}\big[\nabla\mathcal{U}_3\big(X(t,y)-X(t,z)\big)\big]\left(\nabla X(t,x)-\nabla X(t,y)\right)\rho_0(dz)&\\ =\sum_{k=0}^{n}\binom{n}{k}(A_k+B_k),&\end{aligned}$$

with

$$A_k=\int_{\mathbb{R}^3}\partial_t^k\big(\nabla\mathcal{U}_3(X(t,x)-X(t,z))-\nabla\mathcal{U}_3(X(t,y)-X(t,z))\big)\rho_0(dz)\left(\partial_t^{n-k}\nabla X(t,x)\right)$$

$$B_k:=\int_{\mathbb{R}^3}\partial_t^k\big[\nabla\mathcal{U}_3(X(t,y)-X(t,z))\big]\rho_0(dz)\partial_t^{n-k}\big(\nabla X(t,x)-\nabla X(t,y)\big)$$

For A_k, by the Multivariate Faà di Bruno formula (15),

$$\begin{aligned}\partial_t^k\big(\nabla\mathcal{U}_3(X(t,x)-X(t,z))-\nabla\mathcal{U}_3(X(t,y)-X(t,z))\big)\\ = k!\sum_{1\leqslant|\alpha|\leqslant k}\Bigg\{(\partial^\alpha\nabla\mathcal{U}_3)\left(X(t,x)-X(t,z)\right)\sum_{s=1}^{k}\sum_{P_s(k,\alpha)}\prod_{j=1}^{s}\frac{\partial_t^{l_j}(X(t,x)-X(t,z))^{k_j}}{(k_j!)\,(l_j!)^{|k_j|}}\\ -(\partial^\alpha\nabla\mathcal{U}_3)\left(X(t,y)-X(t,z)\right)\sum_{s=1}^{k}\sum_{P_s(k,\alpha)}\prod_{j=1}^{s}\frac{\partial_t^{l_j}(X(t,y)-X(t,z))^{k_j}}{(k_j!)\,(l_j!)^{|k_j|}}\Bigg\},\end{aligned}$$

and therefore

$$\begin{aligned}\partial_t^k\big(\nabla\mathcal{U}_3(X(t,x)-X(t,z))-\nabla\mathcal{U}_3(X(t,y)-X(t,z))\big)\\ = k!\sum_{1\leqslant|\alpha|\leqslant k}G_\alpha(t,x,z)-G_\alpha(t,y,z),\end{aligned}\tag{69}$$

with, for $1\leqslant|\alpha|\leqslant k$,

$$G_\alpha(t,x,z):=(\partial^\alpha\nabla\mathcal{U}_3)\left(X(t,x)-X(t,z)\right)\sum_{s=1}^{k}\sum_{P_s(k,\alpha)}\prod_{j=1}^{s}\frac{\partial_t^{l_j}(X(t,x)-X(t,z))^{k_j}}{(k_j!)\,(l_j!)^{|k_j|}}.$$

We shall use the following Lemma.

Lemma 6.2. *Let $k\geqslant 1$ and $1\leqslant|\alpha|\leqslant k$. Then there exists a constant $C_p\geqslant 2L$ independent of k such that*

$$\int|G_\alpha(t,y,z)|\,\rho_0(dz)\leqslant L\|\rho_0\|_{L^1\cap L^p}\Lambda,\tag{70}$$

and

$$\int|G_\alpha(t,x,z)-G_\alpha(t,y,z)|\,\rho_0(dz)\leqslant\Lambda|x-y|^\mu C_p\|\rho_0\|_{L^1\cap L^p},\tag{71}$$

with

$$\Lambda:=\lambda^{2+|\alpha|}K^{1+|\alpha|}(2+|\alpha|)!\,(K\lambda+1)\left(\sum_{s=1}^{k}\sum_{P_s(k,\alpha)}\prod_{j=1}^{s}\frac{\left\|\partial_t^{l_j}X(t,\cdot)\right\|_{1,\mu}^{|k_j|}}{(k_j!)\,(l_j!)^{|k_j|}}\right).\tag{72}$$

Proof. First, by (58),

$$|G_\alpha(t,x,z)|\leqslant\frac{K^{2+|\alpha|}(2+|\alpha|)!}{|X(t,x)-X(t,z)|^{2+|\alpha|}}\left(\sum_{s=1}^{k}\sum_{P_s(k,\alpha)}\prod_{j=1}^{s}\frac{\left\|\partial_t^{l_j}X(t,\cdot)\right\|_{1,\mu}^{|k_j|}}{(k_j!)\,(l_j!)^{|k_j|}}\right)|x-z|^{|\alpha|},$$

and therefore, by (56),

$$|G_\alpha(t,x,z)|\leqslant\Lambda_1\frac{1}{|x-z|^2},\tag{73}$$

with

$$\Lambda_1=\lambda^{2+|\alpha|}K^{2+|\alpha|}(2+|\alpha|)!\left(\sum_{s=1}^{k}\sum_{P_s(k,\alpha)}\prod_{j=1}^{s}\frac{\left\|\partial_t^{l_j}X(t,\cdot)\right\|_{1,\mu}^{|k_j|}}{(k_j!)\,(l_j!)^{|k_j|}}\right).$$

Observing that, since $\lambda>1$, $\Lambda_1\leqslant\Lambda$, where we recall that Λ is defined in (72), we conclude the proof of (70) using (57).

Next, to prove (71), we first observe that, for any distinct x, y and z in $\mathbb{R}^3$, we have that

$$|G_\alpha(t,x,z)-G_\alpha(t,y,z)|\leqslant\sup_{u\,\in\,S_{x,y}}|\nabla_u G_\alpha(t,u,z)||x-y|,\tag{74}$$

where $S_{x,y}$ is a C^1 path from x to y such that for all $u\in S_{x,y}$,

$$|u-z|\geqslant\min(|z-x|,|z-y|).\tag{75}$$

We refer to [25, Lemma 3.15] for the proof of existence of such a path.

Now, using (58) and (56), we obtain that

$$
\begin{aligned}
&|\partial_u G_\alpha(t,u,z)| \\
&\qquad \leqslant \frac{K^{2+|\alpha|}(2+|\alpha|)!}{|X(t,u)-X(t,z)|^{3+|\alpha|}}|u-z|^{|\alpha|}\left(\sum_{s=1}^{k}\sum_{P_s(k,\alpha)}\prod_{j=1}^{s}\frac{\left\|\partial_t^{l_j}X(t,\cdot)\right\|_{1,\mu}^{|k_j|}}{(k_j!)\,(l_j!)^{|k_j|}}\right) \\
&\qquad + \frac{K^{1+|\alpha|}(1+|\alpha|)!}{|X(t,u)-X(t,z)|^{2+|\alpha|}}|\alpha||u-z|^{|\alpha|-1}\left(\sum_{s=1}^{k}\sum_{P_s(k,\alpha)}\prod_{j=1}^{s}\frac{\left\|\partial_t^{l_j}X(t,\cdot)\right\|_{1,\mu}^{|k_j|}}{(k_j!)\,(l_j!)^{|k_j|}}\right) \\
&\qquad \leqslant \frac{\lambda^{2+|\alpha|}K^{1+|\alpha|}(2+|\alpha|)!\,(K\lambda+1)}{|u-z|^3}\left(\sum_{s=1}^{k}\sum_{P_s(k,\alpha)}\prod_{j=1}^{s}\frac{\left\|\partial_t^{l_j}X(t,\cdot)\right\|_{1,\mu}^{|k_j|}}{(k_j!)\,(l_j!)^{|k_j|}}\right).
\end{aligned}
$$

By combining with (74) and (75), this ensures that

$$
|G_\alpha(t,x,z)-G_\alpha(t,y,z)| \leqslant \Lambda|x-y|\left(\frac{1}{|x-z|^3}+\frac{1}{|y-z|^3}\right), \tag{76}
$$

recalling the definition of Λ in (72).

Now, following the proof of [33, Lemma 2] with the kernel $G_\alpha(t,x,z)$, we set $d := |x-y|$ and observe that, thanks to (73), it is enough to show the result for $d<1$. Indeed if $d=|x-y|\geqslant 1$ then

$$
\begin{aligned}
\int_{\mathbb{R}^3}|G_\alpha(t,x,z)-G_\alpha(t,y,z)|\rho_0(dz) &\leqslant 2\sup_x\int_{\mathbb{R}^3}|G_\alpha(t,x,z)|\rho_0(dz) \\
&\leqslant 2\Lambda_1 L\|\rho_0\|_{L^1\cap L^p} \leqslant 2\Lambda_1 L\|\rho_0\|_{L^1\cap L^p}|x-y|^\mu.
\end{aligned} \tag{77}
$$

Now assume $d<1$, we set $A := \frac{x+y}{2}$, and we split the following integral into three parts:

$$
\int_{\mathbb{R}^3}|G_\alpha(t,x,z)-G_\alpha(t,y,z)|\rho_0(dz) = J_1+J_2+J_3, \tag{78}
$$

where

$$
\begin{aligned}
J_1 &:= \int_{\mathbb{R}^3\setminus B(A,1)}|G_\alpha(t,x,z)-G_\alpha(t,y,z)|\rho_0(dz), \\
J_2 &:= \int_{B(A,1)\setminus B(1,d)}|G_\alpha(t,x,z)-G_\alpha(t,y,z)|\rho_0(dz), \\
J_3 &:= \int_{B(A,d)}|G_\alpha(t,x,z)-G_\alpha(t,y,z)|\rho_0(dz).
\end{aligned}
$$

- For J_1, we have for all $z\in B(A,d)$, $|z-x|\leqslant |z-1|+d/2\leqslant 3d/2$. This yields, by (73), that

$$
\begin{aligned}
J_1 &\leqslant 2\Lambda_1\int_{B(x,3d/2)}\frac{1}{|x-z|^2}\rho_0(dz) \\
&\leqslant C\Lambda_1\left(\int_0^{3d/2}s^{2-2p'}\right)^{1/p'}\|\rho_0\|_{L^p},
\end{aligned}
$$

  and therefore

$$
J_1 \leqslant \widetilde{C}_p\Lambda_1\|\rho_0\|_{L^p}d^{3/p'-2} \leqslant \widetilde{C}_p\Lambda\|\rho_0\|_{L^p}d^{3/p'-2}. \tag{79}
$$

- For J_2 we use that for $z\in B(A,1)\setminus B(A,d)$,

$$
|z-x|>|z-A|-d/2>d/2 \quad\text{and}\quad |z-x|\leqslant |z-A|+d/2\leqslant 1+d/2,
$$

  and (76) to arrive at

$$
\begin{aligned}
J_2 &\leqslant |x-y|\Lambda\int_{B(A,1)\setminus B(1,d)}\left(\frac{1}{|x-z|^3}+\frac{1}{|y-z|^3}\right)\rho_0(dz) \\
&\leqslant C|x-y|\Lambda\|\rho_0\|_{L^p}\left(\int_{d/2}^{1+d/2}s^{2-3p'}\right)^{1/p'}ds,
\end{aligned}
$$

and therefore

$$J_2 \leqslant \widetilde{C}_p|x-y|\Lambda\|\rho_0\|_{L^p}d^{3/p'-3} = \widetilde{C}_p\Lambda\|\rho_0\|_{L^p}d^{3/p'-2}. \tag{80}$$

- For J_3 we have that any z such that $|z-A|>1$ satisfies

$$|z-x| > |z-A| - \frac{1}{2}d > |z-A| - \frac{1}{2} > \frac{1}{2}|z-A|,$$

which yields using (76),

$$J_3 \leqslant \Lambda|x-y|\int_{\mathbb{R}^3\setminus B(A,1)}\left(\frac{1}{|x-z|^3}+\frac{1}{|y-z|^3}\right)\rho_0(dz) \leqslant 16|x-y|\Lambda\|\rho_0\|_{L^1}. \tag{81}$$

By combining (77), (78), (79), (80) and (81), we establish inequality (71) by choosing

$$C_p \geqslant \max\left(2L, 2\widetilde{C}_p + 16\right)$$

This concludes the proof of Lemma 6.2. □

We start with the treatment of the term A_k which is the most difficult. By combining (69) and (71) we first deduce that

$$\begin{aligned}
&\frac{1}{|x-y|^\mu}\int_{\mathbb{R}^3}\left|\partial_t^k\big(\nabla\mathcal{U}_3(X(t,x)-X(t,z)) - \nabla\mathcal{U}_3(X(t,y)-X(t,z))\big)\rho_0(dz)\right| \\
&\qquad\leqslant k!\sum_{1\leqslant|\alpha|\leqslant k}\lambda^{2+|\alpha|}K^{1+|\alpha|}C_p\|\rho_0\|(2+|\alpha|)!\,(K\lambda+1)\left(\sum_{s=1}^{k}\sum_{P_s(k,\alpha)}\prod_{j=1}^{s}\frac{\left\|\partial_t^{l_j}X(t,\cdot)\right\|_{1,\mu}^{|k_j|}}{(k_j!)(l_j!)^{|k_j|}}\right)
\end{aligned}$$

with $\|\rho_0\| = \|\rho_0\|_{L^1\cap L^p}$. Then we use the induction assumption (11), which is assumed to be satisfied up to $n\in\mathbb{N}^*$, to infer that

$$\begin{aligned}
&\frac{1}{|x-y|^\mu}\int_{\mathbb{R}^3}\left|\partial_t^k\big(\nabla\mathcal{U}_3(X(t,x)-X(t,z)) - \nabla\mathcal{U}_3(X(t,y)-X(t,z))\big)\rho_0(dz)\right| \\
&\leqslant k!\sum_{1\leqslant|\alpha|\leqslant k}\lambda^{2+|\alpha|}K^{1+|\alpha|}C_p\|\rho_0\|_{L^1\cap L^p}(2+|\alpha|)!\,(K\lambda+1) \\
&\times\left(\sum_{s=1}^{k}\sum_{P_s(k,\alpha)}\prod_{j=1}^{s}\frac{\left((-1)^{l_j-1}\,(l_j!)\binom{1/2}{l_j}C_0^{l_j}C_1^{l_j-1}\right)^{|k_j|}}{(k_j!)\,(l_j!)^{|k_j|}}\right) \\
&\leqslant k!C_0^kC_1^k(-1)^k\sum_{1\leqslant|\alpha|\leqslant k}\lambda^{2+|\alpha|}C_1^{-|\alpha|}(-1)^{|\alpha|}K^{1+|\alpha|}C_p\|\rho_0\|_{L^1\cap L^p}(2+|\alpha|)!\,(K\lambda+1) \\
&\times\left(\sum_{s=1}^{k}\sum_{P_s(k,\alpha)}\prod_{j=1}^{s}\frac{\binom{1/2}{l_j}^{|k_j|}}{(k_j!)}\right) \\
&= k!C_0^kC_1^k(-1)^k\sum_{1\leqslant|\alpha|\leqslant k}\lambda^2K\left(\lambda C_1^{-1}K\right)^{|\alpha|}C_p\|\rho_0\|_{L^1\cap L^p}2^{3+2|\alpha|}\,(K\lambda+1) \\
&\times\left((-1)^{|\alpha|}|\alpha|!\sum_{s=1}^{k}\sum_{P_s(k,\alpha)}\prod_{j=1}^{s}\frac{\binom{1/2}{l_j}^{|k_j|}}{(k_j!)}\right).
\end{aligned}$$

We now assume that $4\lambda C_1^{-1}K<1$ and

$$\lambda^2KC_p\|\rho_0\|_{L^1\cap L^p}2^3(K\lambda+1) \leqslant \frac{C_0}{2}\frac{C_1}{4}$$

in order to get for $n \neq k$

$$\frac{1}{|x-y|^\mu}\left|\int \partial_t^k\big(\nabla\mathcal{U}_3(X(t,x)-X(t,z))-\nabla\mathcal{U}_3(X(t,y)-X(t,z))\big)\rho_0(dz)\right| \leqslant \frac{1}{4}(k+1)!C_0^{k+1}C_1^{k+1}(-1)^k\binom{1/2}{k+1},$$

by using again (65). Again, we treat the case $n=k$ differently by assuming

$$\lambda^2 K C_p\|\rho_0\|_{L^1\cap L^p}2^3(K\lambda+1)\leqslant\frac{C_0}{2}\frac{1}{4\|\nabla X\|_{0,\mu}},$$

which yields

$$\frac{1}{|x-y|^\mu}\int_{\mathbb{R}^3}\partial_t^n\big(\nabla\mathcal{U}_3(X(t,x)-X(t,z))-\nabla\mathcal{U}_3(X(t,y)-X(t,z))\big)\rho_0(dz) \leqslant \frac{1}{4\|\nabla X\|_{0,\mu}}(n+1)!C_0^{n+1}C_1^n(-1)^n\binom{1/2}{n+1}.$$

We get, by using again (65) and (67), that

$$\begin{aligned}\sum_{k=0}^n\binom{n}{k}\frac{|A_k|}{|x-y|^\mu}&\leqslant\sum_{k=0}^n\binom{n}{k}(k+1)!C_0^{k+1}C_1^{k+1}(-1)^k\frac{1}{4}\binom{1/2}{k+1}\\&\quad\times(-1)^{n-k-1}(n-k)!\binom{1/2}{n-k}C_0^{n-k}C_1^{n-k-1}\\&\leqslant n!\sum_{k=0}^n\frac{1}{4}C_0^{n+1}C_1^n(k+1)(-1)^k\binom{1/2}{k+1}(-1)^{n-k-1}\binom{1/2}{n-k}\\&\leqslant C_0^{n+1}C_1^n(-1)^n(n+1)!\binom{1/2}{n+1},\end{aligned}$$

where we used (68).

Analogously for B_k we emphasize that

$$\partial_t^k\left[\nabla\mathcal{U}_3(X(t,y)-X(t,z))\right]=k!\sum_{1\leqslant|\alpha|\leqslant k}G_\alpha(t,y,z),$$

and that, analogously to (67) we have for $n\neq k$

$$\left|\partial_t^{n-k}\left(\nabla X(t,x)-\nabla X(t,y)\right)\right|\leqslant(-1)^{n-k-1}(n-k)!\binom{1/2}{n-k}C_0^{n-k}C_1^{n-k-1}|x-y|^\mu.$$

Using (70) and the two estimates above, we can treat the term B_k as the term A_k and conclude the proof.

7. Proof of Theorem 2.8

This section is devoted to the proof of Theorem 2.8. By a reversibility argument, it is enough to find a control which sends the initial density ρ_0 to 0 on the time interval $[0,T/2]$, indeed one can then proceed in a similar way and send 0 to the final density ρ_f in the time interval $[T/2,T]$ by switching the time variable t into $T-t$. We emphasize that it is actually sufficient to prove that it is possible to prove that there exists $\epsilon\in(0,\frac{1}{2})$ and a control which steers the initial density ρ_0 to 0 on the time interval $[0,\epsilon T]$, since then one may turn off the control and let the density stays at zero during the rest of the interval $]\epsilon T,T/2[$.

Without loss of generality we assume that there exists $\delta>0$ small enough such that $B(0,4\delta)\subset\omega$.

7.1. Construction of a controlled auxiliary solution starting from 0 and returning at 0.

Following [16], in this subsection we construct, for any $T>0$, a vector field u with zero initial and final values and such that during the imparted time the corresponding flow map sends the support of ρ_0 to the ball $B(0,2\delta)$ in several time steps and then back to the support of ρ_0. More precisely we have the following result.

Proposition 7.1. *Let $T>0$, ω and ρ_0 as above. There exists*

$$f\in C_c\left((0,T);L^\infty\left(\mathbb{R}^3\right)\right),$$

compactly supported in $(0,T)\times\omega$ and

$$(u_{\mathrm{aux}},p_{\mathrm{aux}})\in C_c\left((0,T);\dot{W}^{1,3}\left(\mathbb{R}^3\right)\cap\dot{W}^{2,3}\left(\mathbb{R}^3\right)\right)\bigcap_{q>3}W^{2,q}\left(\mathbb{R}^3\right)\times\bigcap_{q\geqslant3}W^{1,q}\left(\mathbb{R}^3\right),$$

satisfying

$$-\Delta u_{\rm aux}+\nabla p_{\rm aux}=f \quad \text{and} \quad \operatorname{div} u_{\rm aux}=0, \quad \text{on} \quad \mathbb{R}^3,$$

and there exists a covering $\bigcup_{i=1}^{L} B(x_i,r_i)$ *of* $\mathrm{supp}\rho_0$ *and a sequence* $0\leqslant t_i<t_{i+1/4}<t_{i+1/2}<t_{i+1}\leqslant T/2$, $0\leqslant i\leqslant L$ *with* $t_0=T/4$, $t_{L+1}=T/2$ *such that*

$$\forall\ 1\leqslant i\leqslant L,\ \forall\ x\in B(x_i,r_i),\quad \forall\ t\in]t_{i+1/4},t_{i+1/2}[\Rightarrow X_{\rm aux}(t,0,x)\in B(0,2\delta), \tag{82}$$

$$\forall\ 1\leqslant i\leqslant L,\forall\ x\in\mathbb{R}^3, X_{\rm aux}(t_i,0,x)=x.$$

Proof of Proposition 7.1. By a scaling argument we may choose $T=1$. Let $\alpha\in\omega$ and $r>0$ such that $B(\alpha,r)\subset\omega\setminus B(0,4\delta)$. The proof relies on the following Lemma that we prove later.

Lemma 7.2. *Let* $\gamma:[0,1]\to\mathbb{R}^3\setminus\overline{B(\alpha,r)}$ *a curve of class* C^∞ *such that* $\gamma(t)=\gamma(0)$ *for* $t\in[0,\zeta]$ *and* $\gamma(t)=\gamma(1)$*, for* $t\in[1-\zeta,1]$*, for a given small* $\zeta>0$*. Then there exists* $f\in C(0,1,L^\infty(\mathbb{R}^3))$ *compactly supported in* $(0,1)\times B(\alpha,r)$ *and the unique associated solution* $u\in C_c(0,1,\dot W^{2,3}(\mathbb{R}^3)\cap\dot W^{1,3}(\mathbb{R}^3)\bigcap_{q>3}W^{2,q}(\mathbb{R}^3))$ *of*

$$-\Delta u+\nabla p=f,\quad \operatorname{div} u=0,\quad \text{on } \mathbb{R}^3$$

such that the associated characteristic flow X *satisfies* $X(t,0,\gamma(0))=\gamma(t)$.

Now let $a\in\mathrm{supp}\rho_0\setminus\overline{B(\alpha,r)}$. There exists a curve $\gamma_a:[0,1]\to\mathbb{R}^3\setminus\overline{B(\alpha,r)}$ of class C^∞ such that

$$\gamma_a(t)=a \text{ for } t\in[0,1/4],\ \gamma_a(t)=0 \text{ for } t\in[1/2,1]$$

Denote by u_a the velocity and f_a the right hand side obtained by Lemma 7.2 associated to the curve γ_a. By continuity of the flow X_a, there exists $r_a>0$ and $\eta_a>0$ small enough such that for all $x\in B(a,r_a)$ and for all $t\in]1/2-\eta_a,1/2+\eta_a[$ we have $X_a(t,0,x)\in B(0,2\delta)$. We emphasize that the stationarity of the curve near $t=0$ and $t=1$ is crucial in order to have a compactly supported velocity field u_a.

Now for $a\in\mathrm{supp}\rho_0\cap\overline{B(\alpha,r)}$ we consider $B(\beta,r')$ such that $B(\beta,r')\subset\omega\setminus\overline{(B(0,4\delta)\cup B(\alpha,r))}$ and apply Lemma 7.2 for $B(\beta,r')$ instead of $B(\alpha,r)$ in order to drive each point a of $\mathrm{supp}\rho_0\cap\overline{B(\alpha,r)}$ to 0. This yields the existence of a control u_a satisfying a Stokes equation with a right hand side f_a compactly supported in $B(\beta,r')$ and we may apply the same continuity argument as above to get the existence of r_a and η_a such that $X_a(t,0,x)\in B(0,2\delta)$ for $x\in B(a,r_a)$, $t\in]1/2-\eta_a,1/2+\eta_a[$.

Hence, to summarize, for all $a\in\mathrm{supp}\rho_0$, there exists $r_a>0$ and u_a compactly supported in $(0,1)$ which solves the Stokes equation with a right hand side f_a compactly supported in $(0,1)\times\omega$ and such that for all $x\in B(a,r_a)$, in $X_a(t,0,x)\in B(0,2\delta)$ for $t\in]1/4,1/2[$.

By compactness one can extract a finite subcover

$$\bigcup_{i=1}^{L}B(x_i,r_i),$$

of $\mathrm{supp}\rho_0$. Let $(u_i)_i$ the associated velocity fields. We split the time segment $[1/4,1/2]$ by considering the subdivision

$$t_0=1/4,$$

$$t_i=t_0+\frac{i}{4(L+1)},\quad \forall\ i\in\{1,\cdots,L+1\},$$

$$t_{i+1/4}=t_i+\frac{1}{4}\frac{1}{4(L+1)},\quad \forall\ i\in\{0,\cdots,L\},$$

$$t_{i+1/2}=t_i+\frac{1}{2}\frac{1}{4(L+1)},\quad \forall\ i\in\{0,\cdots,L\}.$$

We set then

$$u_{\rm aux}(t,x)=8(L+1)u_i(8(L+1)(t-t_i),x),\ 0\leqslant i\leqslant L,\ t\in[t_i,t_{i+1/2}],$$
$$u_{\rm aux}(t,x)=-8(L+1)u_i(8(L+1)(t_i-t),x),\ 0\leqslant i\leqslant L,\ t\in[t_{i+1/2},t_{i+1}].$$

$u_{\rm aux}$ is then well defined and compactly supported in $(0,T)$ since each u_i is compactly supported. Moreover, $u_{\rm aux}$ solves the Stokes equation on $\mathbb{R}^3\setminus\omega$. Moreover, on each time segment $]t_i,t_{i+1}[$ the domain $B(x_i,r_i)$ is transported inside $B(0,2\delta)$ during the time interval $]t_{i+1/4},t_{i+1/2}[$ and then again to $B(x_i,r_i)$ during the time interval $]t_{i+1/2},t_{i+1}[$, more precisely the characteristic flow $X_{\rm aux}$ associated with $u_{\rm aux}$ satisfies

$$\forall\ 1\leqslant i\leqslant L,\ \forall\ x\in B(x_i,r_i),\quad \forall\ t\in]t_{i+1/4},t_{i+1/2}[\ \Rightarrow X_{\rm aux}(t,0,x)\in B(0,2\delta).$$

$$\forall\ 1\leqslant i\leqslant L,\forall\ x\in\mathbb{R}^3,\ X_{\rm aux}(t_i,0,x)=x.$$

□

Adapting [17, Proposition 3.2.8] to the Stokes context, the proof of Lemma 7.2 relies on the following result which establishes the pointwise reachability of any value in $\mathbb{R}^3$ by velocity vector fields satisfying some controlled steady Stokes systems. For sake of self-containedness, we include below the proof of Lemma 7.2 using Lemma 7.3.

Lemma 7.3. *Let $x \in \mathbb{R}^3 \setminus B(\alpha, r)$, then we have*

$$\Big\{u(x), \exists\ f \in L^\infty\left(\mathbb{R}^3\right)\ \textit{compactly supported in } B(\alpha,r)\ \textit{st} \\ -\Delta u + \nabla p = f\ \textit{and}\ \operatorname{div} u = 0\ \textit{on}\ \mathbb{R}^3\Big\} = \mathbb{R}^3.$$

Proof of Lemma 7.3. We set for a given $x \in \mathbb{R}^3 \setminus B(\alpha, r)$ and any $a \in \mathbb{R}^3$

$$F := 8\pi|x-\alpha|\left(I - \frac{1}{2}\frac{(x-\alpha)\otimes(x-\alpha)}{|x-\alpha|^2}\right)a \in \mathbb{R}^3,$$

we consider then the velocity given by $u = \mathcal{U}(\cdot - \alpha)F$ where we recall that $\mathcal{U}$ is the fundamental solution of the Stokes system in $\mathbb{R}^3$, see Section 3.3. We define as well the associated pressure as $p := \mathcal{P}(\cdot - \alpha)F$. Thus (u, p) satisfies $\operatorname{div} u = 0$ and the steady Stokes equation $-\Delta u + \nabla p = \delta_\alpha F$ on $\mathbb{R}^3$. Moreover,

$$\begin{aligned} u(x) &= \mathcal{U}(x-\alpha)F \\ &= \frac{1}{8\pi}\left(\frac{I}{|x-\alpha|} + \frac{(x-\alpha)\otimes(x-\alpha)}{|x-\alpha|^3}\right)8\pi|x-\alpha|\left(I - \frac{1}{2}\frac{(x-\alpha)\otimes(x-\alpha)}{|x-\alpha|^2}\right)a = a. \end{aligned}$$

In order to regularise the right hand side $\delta_\alpha F$ we set $\widetilde{u} = \mathcal{U} \star \frac{\chi_{B(\alpha,\varepsilon)}}{|B(\alpha,\varepsilon)|}F$ with $\varepsilon < r$ i.e

$$\widetilde{u}(z) = \fint_{B(\alpha,\varepsilon)} \mathcal{U}(z-y)F dy$$

One can show that $|a - \widetilde{u}(x)| = |u(x) - \widetilde{u}(x)| \leqslant C_{x,\alpha}\varepsilon$ for ε small enough and this shows that the set

$$\Big\{u(x), \exists\ f \in L^\infty\left(\mathbb{R}^3\right)\ \text{compactly supported in } B(\alpha,r)\ \text{st} \\ -\Delta u + \nabla p = f, \quad \operatorname{div} u = 0\ \text{on}\ \mathbb{R}^3\Big\},$$

is dense in $\mathbb{R}^3$, since it is a finite dimensional vector space and hence closed, we get the desired equality. □

Proof of Lemma 7.2. Let $\gamma : [0,1] \to \mathbb{R}^3 \setminus \overline{B(\alpha,r)}$ a smooth curve. For any $t \in [0,1]$, thanks to Lemma 7.3, there exists u_i, $i = 1,2,3$ satisfying $-\Delta u_i + \nabla p_i = f_i$ and $\operatorname{div} u_i = 0$ on $\mathbb{R}^3$ for some $f_i \in L^\infty(\mathbb{R}^3)$ compactly supported in $B(\alpha,r)$ such that

$$\det\left[u_1(\gamma(t)), u_2(\gamma(t)), u_3(\gamma(t))\right] \neq 0.$$

By openness of the above condition and continuity of both γ and the functions u_i, one can find a neighbourhood $\mathcal{V}_t$ of t such that for all $s \in \mathcal{V}_t$, the family $\{u_1(\gamma(s)), u_2(\gamma(s)), u_3(\gamma(s))\}$ generates $\mathbb{R}^3$ and hence one can find $\lambda_i(s)$, $i = 1,2,3$ such that for all $s \in \mathcal{V}_t$,

$$\dot{\gamma}(s) = \sum_{i=1}^3 \lambda_i(s)u_i(\gamma(s)) := u^t(s,\gamma(s)).$$

Note that the functions λ_i are continuous on $\mathcal{V}_t$ and hence by linearity, u^t still satisfies a Stokes equation with as a right hand-side the vector field:

$$f^t = \sum_{i=1}^3 \lambda_i(s)f_i \in C\left(\mathcal{V}_t, L^\infty\left(\mathbb{R}^3\right)\right).$$

Now, by compactness of $[0,1]$ one can extract from $\bigcup_{t\in[0,1]}\mathcal{V}_t$ a finite covering $(\mathcal{V}_{t_j})_{1\leqslant j\leqslant M}$ such that for any $s \in [0,1]$ we have

$$\dot{\gamma}(s) = \sum_{j=1}^M \chi_j(s)u^{t_j}(s,\gamma(s)) := u(s,\gamma(s)),$$

where $\chi_1, \cdots, \chi_M$ is a partition of unity adapted to the covering $(\mathcal{V}_{t_j})_{1\leqslant j\leqslant M}$. Finally, one can check that u satisfies the desired properties, in particular the fact that the associated right hand-side

$$f(t) = \sum_{j=1}^M \chi_j(t)f^{t_j}, (t)$$

is compactly supported in $(0,1)$ in time is due to the fact that the curve γ is stationary near $t=0$ and $t=1$. □

In the sequel we will look for a solution (u,ρ) to the transport-Stokes system in $\mathbb{R}^3\setminus\omega$ starting with ρ_0 at time 0, and exactly reaching the null state at time T, whose main part is given by a rescaling of the auxiliary solution $u_{\rm aux}$, while the influence of the initial data will be considered as an error term. More precisely, let $\epsilon>0$, set

$$u^\epsilon_{\rm aux}(t,x):=\frac{1}{\epsilon}u_{\rm aux}\left(\frac{t}{\epsilon},x\right)\quad\text{and}\quad p^\epsilon_{\rm aux}(t,x):=\frac{1}{\epsilon}p_{\rm aux}\left(\frac{t}{\epsilon},x\right),$$

which satisfy

$$-\Delta u^\epsilon_{\rm aux}+\nabla p^\epsilon_{\rm aux}=0\quad\text{in}\quad\mathbb{R}^3\setminus w,\quad \operatorname{div}u^\epsilon_{\rm aux}=0\quad\text{in }\mathbb{R}^3. \tag{83}$$

Let us set accordingly

$$X_\epsilon(t,s,x):=X(t/\epsilon,s,x),$$

the associated flow defined on $[0,\epsilon T]$.

7.2. **Construction of an error term due to the initial density and reaching equilibrium.** This section is devoted to the proof of the following result, where, roughly speaking, it is proved that for $\epsilon>0$ small enough, one may construct an error term, due to the initial density, which reaches equilibrium before the imparted time.

Proposition 7.4. *Let $p\geqslant 3$ and $\rho_0\in L^p_c(\mathbb{R}^3)$. There exists (u^*,ρ^*) in $C([0,+\infty),W^{2,p}(\mathbb{R}^3)\times L^p(\mathbb{R}^3))$ (resp. $C([0,+\infty),\dot W^{2,3}(\mathbb{R}^3)\cap\dot W^{1,3}(\mathbb{R}^3)\cap_{q>3}W^{2,q}\times L^3(\mathbb{R}^3))$ if $p=3$) so that, in $\mathbb{R}^3$, for $\epsilon>0$ small enough,*

$$\left\{\begin{array}{c}\partial_t\rho^*+\operatorname{div}((u^\epsilon_{\rm aux}+u^*)\rho)=g^*,\\ -\Delta u^*+\nabla p=-\rho^*e_3\quad\textit{and}\ \operatorname{div}u^*=0,\ \textit{in }\mathbb{R}^3\\ \rho^*(0,\cdot)=\rho_0\quad\textit{and}\quad\rho^*(\epsilon T,\cdot)=0.\end{array}\right. \tag{84}$$

with $g^*\in L^\infty(0,T\epsilon;L^p(\mathbb{R}^3))$ compactly supported in $(0,\epsilon T)\times\omega$.

Proof of Proposition 7.4. We introduce the following sequence $(\rho^n,u^n)_{n\geqslant 0}$ defined on $[0,\epsilon T]\times\mathbb{R}^3$ such that for $p>3$

$$\|\rho^n\|_{L^1\cap L^p}\leqslant\|\rho_0\|_{L^1\cap L^p},\|u^n\|_{W^{2,p}}\leqslant K, \tag{85}$$

and for $p=3$, $q\geqslant 3$

$$\|\rho^n\|_{L^1\cap L^3}\leqslant\|\rho_0\|_{L^1\cap L^3},\|u^n\|_{W^{1,q}}+\|\nabla u^n\|_{W^{1,3}}\leqslant K, \tag{86}$$

defined as follows.

- We set $(u^0,\rho^0):=(u_0,\rho_0)$ where u_0 the solution to the Stokes equation on $\mathbb{R}^3$ with a right hand side given by $-\rho_0e_3$.
- Given (u^n,ρ^n) satisfying (85), we set $\rho^{n+1/2}$ as

  $$\rho^{n+1/2}:=X^n_\epsilon\#\rho_0$$

  where X^n_ε the characteristic flow associated to $u^\epsilon_{\rm aux}+u^n$. Then $\rho^{n+1/2}$ satisfies weakly

  $$\partial_t\rho^{n+1/2}+\operatorname{div}\left((u^\epsilon_{\rm aux}+u^n)\rho^{n+1/2}\right)=0,\ \text{on }\mathbb{R}^3$$
  $$\rho^{n+1/2}(0,\cdot)=\rho_0.$$

- Using (82) together with (85), there exists $\epsilon_0=C(T,K,\delta,\operatorname{Lip}(u_{\rm aux}))>0$ independent of n such that for all ε in $(0,\varepsilon_0)$,

  $$\forall\, t\in[0,\epsilon T],\ \forall\, x\in B(x_i,r_i),\quad t\in\,]t_{i+1/4},t_{i+1/2}[\Rightarrow X^n_\epsilon(t,0,x)\in B(0,3\delta). \tag{87}$$

  With the same notations as above, let $\{\chi_i\}_{1\leqslant i\leqslant L}$ a partition of unity such that $\operatorname{supp}\chi_i\subset B(x_i,r_i)$. We set then for $t\in[0,\epsilon T]$ and $x\in\mathbb{R}^3$,

  $$\begin{aligned}\rho^{n+1}(t,x):&=\sum_{i=1}^L\beta_i(t)\rho_0(X^n_\varepsilon(0,t,x))\chi_i(X^n_\varepsilon(0,t,x))\\ &=\sum_{i=1}^L\beta_i(t)\rho^{n+1/2}(t,x)\chi_i(X^n_\varepsilon(0,t,x)),\end{aligned}$$

with $\beta_i(t) := \beta\left(8(L+1)(t-t_i)\right)$ with β a cutoff function such that $\beta = 1$ for $t \leqslant 1/2$ and $\beta = 0$ for $t \geqslant 1$. We observe that ρ^{n+1} satisfies weakly

$$\begin{aligned} \partial_t \rho^{n+1} + \operatorname{div}\left((u^\epsilon_{\text{aux}} + u^n)\rho^{n+1}\right) &= g^n \text{ on } \mathbb{R}^3 \\ \rho^{n+1}(0,\cdot) = \rho_0 \quad \text{and} \quad \rho^{n+1}(\epsilon T,\cdot) &= 0, \end{aligned} \tag{88}$$

with

$$g^n(t,x) := \sum_{i=1}^{L} \beta_i'(t)\rho_0(X^n_\varepsilon(0,t,x))\chi_i(X^n_\varepsilon(0,t,x)).$$

- Finally we define u^{n+1} as the unique solution to the Stokes equation:

$$-\Delta u^{n+1} + \nabla p^{n+1} = -\rho^{n+1} e_3 \quad \text{and} \quad \operatorname{div} u^{n+1} = 0 \quad \text{in} \quad \mathbb{R}^3. \tag{89}$$

Lemma 7.5. *The vector fields g^n are compactly supported in $(0,\epsilon T)\times\omega$.*

Proof of Lemma 7.5. If $g^n(t,x) \neq 0$ there exists $1 \leqslant i \leqslant L$ such that $\beta_i'(t)\rho_0(X^n_\varepsilon(0,t,x))\chi_i(X^n_\varepsilon(0,t,x)) \neq 0$ hence $t \in \epsilon]t_{i+1/4}, t_{i+1/2}[$ with $X^n_\epsilon(0,t,x) \in \operatorname{supp}\rho_0 \cap B(x_i,r_i)$ which yields $x \in X^n_\epsilon(t,0,B(x_i,r_i)) \subset \omega$ according to (87). □

The sequences ρ^n and g^n satisfy the following uniform bounds for all $q \in [0,+\infty]$,

$$\|g^n\|_{L^q(0,\epsilon T;L^1\cap L^p)} + \|\rho^n\|_{L^q(0,\epsilon T;L^1\cap L^p)} + \|\partial_t\rho^n\|_{L^q\left(0,\epsilon T;L^p+\dot{W}^{-1,p}\right)} \leqslant M$$

which yields for u^n using the fact that $-\Delta\partial_t u^n + \nabla\partial_t p^n = -\partial_t\rho^n e_3$, $\operatorname{div}\partial_t u^n = 0$,

$$\begin{aligned} \|u^n\|_{L^q(0,\epsilon T;W^{2,p})} + \|\partial_t u^n\|_{L^q\left(0,\epsilon T;\dot{W}^{1,p}\right)} &\leqslant M, \text{ if } p > 3, \\ \|u^n\|_{L^q\left(0,\epsilon T;W^{2,3}_{\text{loc}}\right)} + \|\partial_t u^n\|_{L^q\left(0,\epsilon T;\dot{W}^{-1,3}\right)} &\leqslant M, \text{ if } p = 3. \end{aligned}$$

Hence using the Aubin–Lions Theorem we get the convergence of a subsequence $u^n \to u^*$ in $L^q(0,\epsilon T; C^{1,\mu}_{\text{loc}} \cap W^{1,p}_{\text{loc}}(\mathbb{R}^3))$ if $p > 3$. This allows us to pass in the limit in the weak formulations of the Stokes equations (89) and the transport equation (88), using the weak convergence $\rho^n \rightharpoonup \rho^*$ and $g^n \rightharpoonup g^*$ in $L^q(0,\epsilon T; L^p)$. For $p = 3$ we get analogously $u^n \to u^*$ in $L^q(0,\epsilon T, W^{1,3}_{\text{loc}}(\mathbb{R}^3))$ together with $\rho^n \rightharpoonup \rho^*$ weakly in $L^q(0,\epsilon T; L^s)$ for any $1 \leqslant s \leqslant 3$ which allows us to pass in the transport equation for $s = 3/2$, so that, in $\mathbb{R}^3$, (84) holds true.

We emphasize that an Ascoli-type argument similar to the one used in the proof of Theorem 1.1 still holds true for the sequence of flows X^n_ϵ and we get $X^n_\epsilon(\cdot,s,\cdot) \to X^*(\cdot,s,\cdot)$ in $C[0,\epsilon T], C^1_{\text{loc}})$ (resp. in $C[0,\epsilon T], C_{\text{loc}})$) if $p > 3$ (resp. $p = 3$).

This allows us to get a pointwise convergence of g^n to

$$g^* = \sum_{i=1}^{L} \partial_t\beta_i(t)\rho_0(X^*(0,t,x))\chi_i(X^*(0,t,x)),$$

in $(0,\epsilon T)\times\mathbb{R}^3$ and ensures that g^* is compactly supported in $(0,\epsilon T)\times\omega$. Moreover, passing in the limit, pointwise, in the identity:

$$\rho^{n+1}(t,x) := \sum_{i=1}^{L} \beta_i(t)\rho_0(X^n_\varepsilon(0,t,x))\chi_i(X^n_\varepsilon(0,t,x)),$$

we obtain that ρ^* is in $C(0,T;L^p)$ and the continuity for the velocity u^* as well. This concludes the proof of Proposition 7.4. □

7.3. **Conclusion of the proof of Theorem 2.8.** Combining Proposition 7.1 and Proposition 7.5, in particular by (83) and (84), and since g^* is compactly supported in $(0,\epsilon T)\times\omega$, the vector field ($u := u^\epsilon_{\text{aux}} + u^*, \rho := \rho^*$) satisfies

$$\begin{aligned} \partial_t\rho + \operatorname{div}(\rho u) = 0 \quad &\text{in} \quad \mathbb{R}^3 \setminus \omega, \\ -\Delta u + \nabla p = -\rho e_3 \quad &\text{in}\mathbb{R}^3 \setminus \omega, \\ \operatorname{div} u = 0 \quad &\text{in} \quad \mathbb{R}^3, \\ \rho(0,\cdot) = \rho_0 \quad &\text{and} \quad \rho(T\epsilon,\cdot) = 0. \end{aligned}$$

Recalling the preliminary remark at the beginning of this section, this concludes the proof of Theorem 2.8.

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